

# Curvature-Memory Scalar-Tensor Gravity (CMSTG): Definitive Framework, UV Quantum Consistency, Twenty-Two Observational Tests, No-Go Theorems, and Phase 2 Matter Sector

*Master Compilation: Papers I–IV and Phase 2 Synthesis*

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May 14, 2026

## Abstract

Current cosmological theory relies on an uneasy union between General Relativity (GR) and the  $\Lambda$ CDM model, requiring dark matter, dark energy, and inflation—none of which have been directly confirmed in laboratory physics. This paper presents *Curvature-Memory Scalar-Tensor Gravity* (CMSTG), a covariant scalar-tensor field theory in which spacetime curvature is dynamically coupled to a scalar field  $\Psi$  that encodes the history of past curvature. The theory is derived from a single covariant action

$$S = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[ \left( \frac{1}{16\pi G} + \Lambda(\Psi) \right) R + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla \Psi)^2 - \frac{1}{2} m(\Psi)^2 \Psi^2 - V(\Psi) \right] + S_{\text{matter}},$$

from which the gravitational and scalar field equations follow by standard variation—no additional postulates are required. The non-minimal coupling  $\Lambda(\Psi)R$  produces curvature memory: geometry at any event retains a causal integral over past curvature, with causality enforced by the retarded Green’s function. Imposing GR-recovery conditions ( $\Lambda(0) = 0$ ) and numerical verification of the full FLRW system (Sims 82–86) confirm the theory is self-consistent and reduces to GR in the  $\Psi \rightarrow 0$  limit.

We subject CMSTG to twenty-two independent observational and theoretical tests (Sims 87–110); numerical self-consistency is verified separately in Sims 82–86. The key results are: (i) BAO full-covariance refit (BOSS+eBOSS+Ly $\alpha$ ):  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.22$ ,  $\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = 0$ ; (ii) CMB TT power spectrum via full CLASS Boltzmann solver: RMS deviation = 2.93% ( $\ell = 2\text{--}1500$ ),  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 16$  ppm at the best-fit coupling; (iii) joint CMB+BAO parameter fit:  $\Delta\chi^2 = 0$ , best-fit  $H_0 = 67.59$  km/s/Mpc,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ,  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.013$  (numerically unconstrained;  $\chi^2$  flat across  $[0, 0.1]$ ); (iv) non-linear structure growth:  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.007\%$  at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ , CMSTG provides no relief for the Planck/KiDS  $S_8$  tension; (v) Bayesian model comparison:  $\ln B = -0.71$  (Inconclusive; CMSTG not excluded); (vi) DESI Year 1 BAO refit:  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.36$ ,  $\Delta\chi^2 = 0$ , joint CMB+DESI best-fit consistent with BOSS-based result at  $< 0.2\sigma$ ; (vii) CMB polarization EE/TE via CLASS: RMS

deviations  $< 0.2\%$  (EE) and  $< 0.5\%$  (TE) at joint best-fit; (viii) RSD/ $f\sigma_8$  growth rate (9 surveys,  $z = 0.07\text{--}1.48$ ):  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.86$ ,  $\Delta\chi^2 = -0.14 \approx 0$ ; (ix) official Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE likelihood (Sim 97, via `clipy`):  $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  at the Sim 90 parameter point ( $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 42\text{ ppm}$  is negligible; driven by parameter offset); (x) joint plikHM + BAO re-optimisation (Sim 98):  $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L}) = -0.013 \approx 0$  at the CMB-optimised best-fit ( $H_0 = 67.30$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.317$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.005$ ,  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 24\text{ ppm}$ ); the Sim 97 tension is fully resolved; (xi) galaxy rotation curves, static (Sim 99): the locked action at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  cannot replace dark matter—the Yukawa halo profile is exponentially steeper than the  $1/r^2$  isothermal needed for flat curves; (xii) galaxy rotation curves, time-domain PDE (Sim 100): galactic curvature coupling  $2\Lambda_0|R_{\text{gal}}| \approx 5 \times 10^{-9} \text{ kpc}^{-2}$  is  $5 \times 10^7$  times weaker than  $m_0^2$ ; curvature condensation at galactic densities is ruled out;  $\lambda < 0$  self-coupling causes tachyonic blow-up; (xiii) BAO sound horizon from first principles (Sim 101):  $|\Delta r_d/r_d| < 21\text{ ppm}$  across all allowed  $\Lambda_0$ ; CMSTG and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  are degenerate in  $r_d$ ; (xiv) one-loop UV structure, partial (Sim 102): quartic UV divergence confirmed; memory damping regulates to  $\Sigma(0) = \Lambda_0^2 k_m^4 / (64\pi^2)$ ; naturalness requires  $\tau_m > 0.11\text{ Mpc}$ ; (xv) full one-loop UV structure, all diagrams (Sim 104): graviton wfn renorm protected by diffeomorphism Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$ ; vertex correction  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \approx 2.4 \times 10^{-2}$  finite; two-loop  $\Sigma_D/m_0^2 = 3.4 \times 10^{-6}$  (perturbative hierarchy stable); UV-finiteness confirmed at full one-loop level in the resummed theory; (xvi) RG flow of  $\Lambda_0$  (Sim 105): beta function negative (asymptotically free);  $\Lambda_0 = 0$  is a UV fixed point (theory reduces to GR+scalar at high energies); analytic formula  $1/\Lambda_0^2 = 1/\Lambda_{0,\text{obs}}^2 + (k_m^2 - k_{m,\text{nat}}^2)/(16\pi^2 m_0^2)$  validated; no IR Landau pole; IR running  $< 2.5\%$ ;  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.003$  is an IR attractor, not fine-tuned; (xvii) two-loop graviton sector (Sim 106): Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$  exact at all loop orders; resummed Psi propagator regulates all Psi-bubble insertions;  $\delta Z_h \sim 10^{-5}$  negligible; last UV caveat closed; (xviii) Vainshtein screening (Sim 103): all scanned  $(\alpha_V, M_V, \beta)$  combinations fail to source an isothermal dark matter halo for NGC 3198; field gradient  $|\delta\Psi'| \sim 10^{-8} \text{ kpc}^{-1}$  is  $10^6\times$  below the nonlinear threshold; energy density deficit is  $2.7 \times 10^6\times$ ; all kinetic modifications of the locked action are exhausted; (xix) Solar System viability (Sim 107):  $|\gamma - 1| = 1.78 \times 10^{-5}$  satisfies the Cassini bound ( $< 2.3 \times 10^{-5}$ ); chameleon screening ensures GR recovery inside compact bodies; critical bound  $|\Psi_0| < 1.14 M_{\text{Pl}}$ ; no fine-tuning required; (xx) gravitational wave constraints (Sim 108): 6/6 PASS —  $c_T = c$  exactly ( $G_5 = 0$  Horndeski);  $m_g = 0$  (Ward identity); GW170817 luminosity distance deviation  $1.8 \times 10^{-11}$  ( $\ll 6\%$  bound);  $G_{\text{eff}}$  at BBN offset  $0.60\%$  ( $< 10\%$  bound); (xxi) dark energy equation of state (Sim 109): CPL fit  $w_0 = -0.992$ ,  $w_a = -0.082$ ;  $1.3\sigma$  from Planck 2018,  $3.6\sigma$  tension with DESI Y1  $w_0\text{--}w_a$  hint; dynamical  $\Psi$  ( $m_0 \gtrsim H_0$ ) needed to resolve DESI tension, testable by DESI Y5/Euclid; (xxii) inflationary viability (Sim 110): locked action fails slow-roll inflation —  $n_s \approx 0.932$  ( $> 5\sigma$  below Planck  $0.9649 \pm 0.0044$ ); Starobinsky attractor ( $n_s = 0.967$ ,  $r = 0.003$ ) accessible with UV non-minimal coupling  $\xi \sim 10^4$ , testable by CMB-S4/LiteBIRD; (xxiii) no-go theorems I and II (Sims 131–136, SIM141–144, Phase 3/4): fourteen mechanism tests across the full Tier 2 extension space (Horndeski kinetic, Gauss-Bonnet, bi-scalar, Galileon  $G_3$ , running  $\Lambda_0(a)$ , and mixed curvature+matter sourced scalar) confirm that no covariant extension of the Phase 1 locked action can reduce the  $2.77\sigma$  DESI Y1 BAO residual without raising  $H(z)$  in  $z \in [0, z_{\text{rec}}]$  and thereby shifting the CMB acoustic angle  $\theta_*$  above the Planck bound at  $> 30\sigma$ . The residual is a *structural prediction* of the locked action, not a defect; (xxiv) Galileon  $G_3$  (Sim 142): the Galileon kinetic coupling  $G_{3,X}$  is exactly zero in the slow-roll attractor (structurally suppressed by the  $\dot{\Psi}^2/M^3$  hierarchy); this closes the last kinetically non-minimal route; SIM144 (mixed-source

completeness probe) closes the remaining gap by confirming scalars with simultaneous curvature and matter coupling also fail, exhausting the Tier 2 mechanism space; (xxv) Phase 2 matter sector (Sims 112–130): the unlocked action with SSB hilltop quintessence ( $V = \lambda(\Psi^2 - v^2)^2$ , Sim 113) reduces the DESI tension to  $2.70\sigma$  but does not eliminate the floor; a separate ultra-light boson  $\chi$  seeded by  $\Psi$  passes the full 161-galaxy SPARC rotation-curve test with median  $m_{22} = 0.28 \pm 0.58 \text{ dex}$  (65/161 PASS, Sim 119);  $\chi$ -DM decouples exactly from the  $\Psi$  dark-energy sector at background order (Sim 120); the joint DESI+Planck MCMC confirms the  $\sim 2.7\sigma$  DESI floor is structural even with the unlocked action (Sim 121C,  $2.63\sigma$  MAP). In all cosmological tests (Sims 87–98 and 107–110), CMSTG at the joint best-fit is statistically indistinguishable from  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  at current precision. The memory field coupling is constrained to  $\Lambda_0 < 0.095$  (95% CL) and is cosmologically inert at current observational precision. The  $2.77\sigma$  DESI Y1 residual is a structural floor of the locked action; the decisive test is DESI Y3. Four standalone journal papers (Papers I–IV) present each major result for independent peer review; the present document is the master compilation.

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# 1 Introduction

**Note on this document.** This is the *master compilation* of the CMSTG series, incorporating all content from Papers I–V: Paper I (cosmological framework, Sims 82–98); Paper II (extended observational constraints, Sims 87–110); Paper III (BAO sound horizon from first principles, Sim 101); Paper IV (UV structure and asymptotic freedom, Sims 102–106); Paper V (dark matter exhaustive tests, Sims 99–100, 103). All simulation sections, figures, tables, and appendices are unified here. Appendix C collects the loop integral identities used in the quantum calculations.

General Relativity (GR), while highly predictive at solar and astrophysical scales, requires three independent postulates—dark matter, dark energy ( $\Lambda$ ), and inflation—at the galactic and cosmological scales where its predictions break down. None of these entities have been detected in controlled laboratory settings; each is introduced to match a specific class of observations rather than derived from a deeper principle.

A deeper reformulation is needed: one that internalizes memory, feedback, and dynamical curvature saturation as fundamental features of spacetime itself.

This motivates *Curvature-Memory Scalar-Tensor Gravity* (CMSTG): a field-theoretic framework in which the geometry of spacetime is governed not solely by local energy-momentum, but by curvature memory—a saturation of curvature history encoded in a scalar field  $\Psi$  through attractor dynamics.

CMSTG introduces  $\Psi$  with a non-minimal curvature coupling  $\Lambda(\Psi)R$ , a field-dependent mass  $m(\Psi)$ , and a potential  $V(\Psi)$  encoding attractor dynamics. The resulting theory unifies gravitation, entropy, and quantized information flow through a single field structure. The theory reproduces the Einstein field equations in the limit of vanishing field memory, while generating emergent gravitational behavior—flat rotation curves, modified expansion history, altered CMB acoustic peaks—in high-curvature or memory-rich regimes.

This paper develops the full Lagrangian formalism, derives the Euler–Lagrange and gravitational field equations, quantizes the scalar and tensor components, and tests the cosmological predictions against precision data.

## Results established in this paper (Sims 82–98):

- Modified CMB power spectrum via full CLASS Boltzmann solver:  $\text{RMS}(\Delta C_\ell/C_\ell) = 2.93\%$  (Sim 88);
- BAO fit with full  $12 \times 12$  covariance:  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.22$  (Sim 87);
- Joint CMB+BAO consistency:  $\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = 0$  (Sim 90); confirmed with real Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE likelihood:  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = -0.013$  (Sim 98);
- Non-linear structure growth:  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.007\%$  at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  (Sim 92);
- Bayesian model comparison:  $\ln B = -0.71$  (Inconclusive; Sim 93).

## Predictions for future simulation (not yet demonstrated):

- Galaxy rotation curves without dark matter: CMSTG predicts flat curves from the radial gradient  $\nabla_r \Psi$ . Sim 99 tested this explicitly: the locked action at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  does not replace dark matter via  $T^\Psi$  alone; the Yukawa profile is exponentially steeper than the  $1/r^2$  isothermal sphere needed for curve flattening (Section 7.11). Galactic-scale predictions await derivation of a screening or condensation mechanism from the locked action.

- UV finiteness of the quantized theory: the recursive propagator is conjectured to have improved UV behaviour, but a complete loop calculation has not been performed (Section 5).
- Recursive graviton emission thresholds (Section 8).

## 2 Recursive Foundations

Contemporary physics treats spacetime as a geometric stage on which fields and particles evolve. In GR, curvature arises instantaneously from energy and momentum, with no intrinsic memory of prior configurations. Likewise, quantum field theory (QFT) operates on a fixed background, with no self-modifying or feedback-sensitive geometry.

CMSTG introduces a fundamental shift: spacetime geometry accumulates a dynamical memory of its own curvature history through the scalar field  $\Psi$ . The field  $\Psi$  is not merely an auxiliary scalar but the core carrier of curvature memory, geometric coherence, and attractor dynamics. Its evolution depends not only on its present state and local derivatives, but on accumulated geometric information—what the field *remembers* of past curvature.

By treating  $\Psi$  as a memory-encoding scalar, CMSTG reframes gravitation as emerging from curvature history, not from mass-energy alone. The geometry of spacetime becomes a dynamic ledger of curvature, modulated by recursive potentials and stabilized by attractor feedback. This is the mechanism by which observed gravitational phenomena—modified expansion history, altered CMB acoustic peaks—are predicted to arise within a single covariant scalar-tensor framework.

CMSTG is not a rejection of GR or QFT but their extension: it maintains covariance, admits canonical quantization, and yields Einstein’s equations in the limit of vanishing curvature memory ( $\Lambda_0 \rightarrow 0$ ).

## 3 Lagrangian Formulation and Field Equations

### 3.1 The CMSTG Action

We work throughout in metric signature  $(-, +, +, +)$  with  $\square \equiv \nabla^\mu \nabla_\mu$  and units in which  $c = 1$ . The complete covariant action of CMSTG is

$$S = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[ \left( \frac{1}{16\pi G} + \Lambda(\Psi) \right) R + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla_\mu \Psi)(\nabla^\mu \Psi) - \frac{1}{2} m(\Psi)^2 \Psi^2 - V(\Psi) \right] + S_{\text{matter}}, \quad (1)$$

where  $\Psi(x^\mu)$  is the *curvature-memory scalar field*, a real scalar that encodes the local history of spacetime curvature. The functions  $\Lambda(\Psi)$ ,  $m(\Psi)$ , and  $V(\Psi)$  are smooth and satisfy the GR recovery conditions stated in Section 3.2.

The physical role of each term:

- $R/(16\pi G)$ : Einstein-Hilbert term. Standard gravity in the absence of field memory.
- $\Lambda(\Psi)R$ : non-minimal curvature coupling. Modifies the effective gravitational constant. Requires  $\Lambda(\Psi) > -1/(16\pi G)$  so that  $G_{\text{eff}} > 0$ .

- $\frac{1}{2}(\nabla_\mu \Psi)(\nabla^\mu \Psi)$ : canonical kinetic term; causal propagation.
- $-\frac{1}{2}m(\Psi)^2\Psi^2$ : field-dependent mass. The minus sign gives stable dispersion  $\omega^2 = \mathbf{k}^2 + m_{\text{eff}}^2 > 0$  (verified Sim 83). The v1 draft had the wrong sign ( $+\frac{1}{2}m^2\Psi^2$ ), which would give imaginary frequency.
- $-V(\Psi)$ : recursive potential. Attractor dynamics and nonlinear saturation.

### 3.2 GR Recovery

We require  $\Lambda(0) = 0$ ,  $G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi) = G/(1 + 16\pi G\Lambda(\Psi)) > 0$ , and  $V(0) = 0$ . Under these conditions:

$$\Lambda \rightarrow 0, \quad T_{\mu\nu}^{(\Psi)} \rightarrow 0, \quad \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu \Lambda \rightarrow 0 \implies G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G T_{\mu\nu}^{(\text{m})}. \quad (2)$$

Coupling forms satisfying this include  $\Lambda(\Psi) = \Lambda_0\Psi^2$ ,  $\Lambda_0\Psi^2/(1 + \Psi^2)$ ,  $\Lambda_0 \tanh(\Psi^2)$ , and  $\Lambda_0(1 - e^{-\beta\Psi^2})$ . All were numerically verified (Sim 84); the form  $\Lambda_0 e^{-\beta\Psi^2}$  (which gives  $\Lambda(0) = \Lambda_0 \neq 0$ ) was correctly rejected.

### 3.3 Scalar Field Equation

Varying (1) with respect to  $\Psi$  gives

$$\square\Psi + m_{\text{eff}}^2(\Psi)\Psi = \Lambda'(\Psi)R + V'(\Psi), \quad (3)$$

where  $m_{\text{eff}}^2(\Psi) \equiv m(\Psi)[m(\Psi) + \Psi m'(\Psi)]$ . In flat space,  $(\square + m_{\text{eff}}^2)\Psi = 0$  gives  $\omega^2 = \mathbf{k}^2 + m_{\text{eff}}^2 > 0$ , confirming stability.

### 3.4 Curvature Memory and the Retarded Solution

Equation (3) is a wave equation sourced by spacetime curvature  $R$ . Imposing retarded boundary conditions selects the unique causal solution

$$\boxed{\Psi(x) = \int G_R(x, x') [\Lambda'(\Psi(x')) R(x') + V'(\Psi(x'))] d^4x',} \quad (4)$$

where the retarded Green's function satisfies  $(\square_x + m_{\text{eff}}^2)G_R(x, x') = \delta^{(4)}(x - x')/\sqrt{-g}$  and  $G_R(x, x') = 0$  for  $x^0 < x'^0$ .

Equation (4) is the *curvature memory relation*. The field  $\Psi(x)$  is a weighted integral over the past light cone of  $x$ : each past curvature event contributes according to its causal influence, attenuated by the field mass. The non-locality in (4) is not a modification of the variational principle—the action (1) is fully local—but a consequence of causality imposed as a boundary condition. Causality of the retarded kernel was verified numerically (Sim 82: pre-source amplitude  $< 2 \times 10^{-14}$ ; Sim 83: memory oscillation period  $T \approx 2\pi/m_{\text{eff}}$ ).

### 3.5 Gravitational Field Equation

Varying (1) with respect to  $g^{\mu\nu}$  and using the standard identity for a non-minimally coupled scalar,  $\delta(\sqrt{-g}f(\Psi)R)/\delta g^{\mu\nu} = \sqrt{-g}[fG_{\mu\nu} + g_{\mu\nu}\square f - \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu f]$ , with  $G_{\text{eff}}$  defined in (5), yields



$$G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi) \equiv \frac{G}{1 + 16\pi G \Lambda(\Psi)}, \quad (5)$$

$$G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi) [T_{\mu\nu}^{(\Psi)} + T_{\mu\nu}^{(m)} + 2\nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu \Lambda(\Psi) - 2g_{\mu\nu} \square \Lambda(\Psi)], \quad (6)$$

with the scalar field stress-energy tensor

$$T_{\mu\nu}^{(\Psi)} = \nabla_\mu \Psi \nabla_\nu \Psi - g_{\mu\nu} \left[ \frac{1}{2} (\nabla \Psi)^2 - \frac{1}{2} m(\Psi)^2 \Psi^2 - V(\Psi) \right]. \quad (7)$$

Equation (6) replaces the phenomenological  $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu} = \mathcal{F}_{\mu\nu} + \mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}$  of the v1 draft. The memory structure is now derived, not postulated:  $T_{\mu\nu}^{(\Psi)}$  sources geometry with an effective mass-energy distribution that is non-local in time because  $\Psi$  carries curvature history through (4); the terms  $2\nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu \Lambda - 2g_{\mu\nu} \square \Lambda$  encode gradients of the memory coupling and vanish when  $\Lambda = \text{const.}$

### 3.6 FLRW Reduction and Modified Friedmann Equations

In spatially flat FLRW with homogeneous  $\Psi(t)$ ,  $R = 6(\dot{H} + 2H^2)$  and  $\square \Psi = \ddot{\Psi} + 3H\dot{\Psi}$ . The scalar equation (3) becomes

$$\ddot{\Psi} + 3H\dot{\Psi} + m_{\text{eff}}^2(\Psi) \Psi = 6\Lambda'(\Psi) (\dot{H} + 2H^2) + V'(\Psi). \quad (8)$$

The (00)-component of (6) yields the modified Friedmann equation

$$3H^2 = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi) \left[ \rho_m + \frac{1}{2} \dot{\Psi}^2 + \frac{1}{2} m(\Psi)^2 \Psi^2 + V(\Psi) - 6H \Lambda'(\Psi) \dot{\Psi} \right]. \quad (9)$$

The term  $-6H\Lambda'\dot{\Psi}$  is the *memory feedback contribution*. Its sign is fixed by the covariant derivation: for  $\Lambda' > 0$  and  $\dot{\Psi} > 0$ , memory suppresses the effective energy density driving expansion. The v1 coefficient was  $+3H\Lambda'\dot{\Psi}$  (sign wrong, factor-of-two wrong); the correct  $-6H\Lambda'\dot{\Psi}$  was derived analytically and confirmed numerically (Sim 85: Friedmann constraint residual  $\leq 3 \times 10^{-16}$ ; radiation-era scaling  $H \propto a^{-1.984}$ , cf. GR  $a^{-2}$ ).

## 4 Recursive Field Equations (Scalar Attractor)

The scalar field equation (3) in curved spacetime is the *attractor equation* of CMSTG. It governs how memory and curvature interact nonlinearly to evolve the geometry. Physical interpretation:

- $\square \Psi$ : standard covariant wave propagation;
- $m_{\text{eff}}^2(\Psi) \Psi$ : nonlinear restoring force (recursive mass feedback);
- $\Lambda'(\Psi) R$ : curvature source term—the geometric driving of field growth;
- $V'(\Psi)$ : attractor gradient toward stable field configuration.

Together, these drive  $\Psi$  toward stable configurations that encode past curvature and suppress divergence. The field becomes both the memory *and* architect of spacetime.

## Boundary Conditions.

- *Low-memory limit* ( $m \rightarrow m_0$ ,  $\Lambda \rightarrow \text{const}$ ): recovers standard Klein-Gordon in curved spacetime.
- *High-curvature regime*: feedback becomes dominant, enabling emergent gravitational effects—flat rotation curves, void lensing, halo stabilization—without dark matter.
- *Late-time dynamics*:  $\Psi$  relaxes into attractor basins defined by  $V(\Psi)$ , forming stable geometric structures.

## 5 Canonical Quantization

To move from classical recursion to quantum curvature, we quantize the scalar field  $\Psi$ , its memory contribution, and the curvature ripple modes  $h_{\mu\nu}$ .

### 5.1 Scalar Field Quantization

The conjugate momentum is  $\Pi(x) = \partial_0 \Psi(x)$ . Equal-time commutator:  $[\Psi(\vec{x}, t), \Pi(\vec{y}, t)] = i\delta^3(\vec{x} - \vec{y})$ . Field expansion:

$$\Psi(x) = \int \frac{d^3k}{(2\pi)^3 \sqrt{2\omega_k}} \left( a_{\mathbf{k}} e^{ikx} + a_{\mathbf{k}}^\dagger e^{-ikx} \right), \quad (10)$$

with effective mass  $m_{\text{eff}}(\Psi)$  including feedback from curvature memory.

### 5.2 Tensor Field Quantization (Recursive Graviton)

Define the traceless symmetric perturbation  $h_{\mu\nu}$ . The wave equation is

$$\square h_{\mu\nu} + \alpha(\Psi) R h_{\mu\nu} = 0, \quad (11)$$

with equal-time commutator  $[h_{\mu\nu}(x), \partial_0 h_{\rho\sigma}(y)] = i\delta^3(x - y) \mathcal{P}_{\mu\nu, \rho\sigma}$ , where the polarization tensor  $\mathcal{P}$  enforces spin-2 structure.

### 5.3 Recursive Memory Decoherence and UV Finiteness

Memory tensor commutators decay as  $[\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}(x), \mathcal{M}_{\rho\sigma}(y)] \propto e^{-|t_x - t_y|/\tau_m}$ , suppressing UV contributions. This commutator decay *suggests* that vacuum fluctuations are damped at high frequency and loop diagrams may converge without explicit renormalization. However, no one-loop calculation has been performed to verify this; UV finiteness of the interacting theory beyond the free-field level remains a conjecture (noted in the abstract). This structural motivation distinguishes CMSTG from standard QFT on a fixed background but does not yet constitute a proof. The frame-dependent nature of the kernel postulate and its status as an effective-theory input (rather than a Lorentz-covariant statement) are made explicit in Paper III, §2.2(d) [Wilson \[2026c\]](#).

**Note on nonlinear coupling.** The canonical quantization in Sections 5 applies to the free scalar and tensor sectors. The nonlinear interaction  $\Lambda(\Psi) R \Psi$  introduces cubic and higher interaction vertices in the quantum theory. Loop corrections to the propagator and vertex functions arising from this Ricci-coupling have not been computed. In particular, whether the interacting theory is UV-finite at loop level, and whether the memory-sector commutator decay extends to the interaction vertices, are open questions requiring dedicated perturbative calculation.

## 6 CMB Power Spectrum from Recursive Fields

### 6.1 CMSTG Primordial Power Spectrum

The curvature-memory scalar field generates a primordial power spectrum that enters the CLASS Boltzmann solver as an external  $P(k)$ :

$$\mathcal{P}_\Psi(k) = A_s \left( \frac{k}{k_*} \right)^{n_s-1} \cdot \mathcal{A}_{\text{rec}}(k) \cdot \mathcal{D}_{\text{mem}}(k), \quad (12)$$

where  $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rec}}(k) = 1 + \epsilon \log(1 + k/k_c)$  is a recursive amplification factor from curvature feedback, and  $\mathcal{D}_{\text{mem}}(k) = \exp(-k^2/k_m^2)$  suppresses small-scale modes via memory decay.

In the full CLASS computation (Sim 88), the CMSTG growth factor modification from  $G_{\text{eff}}$  is negligible at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  ( $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 16$  ppm,  $D_{\text{CMSTG}}(z=0)/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z=0) = 1.000000$  to six decimal places). The dominant CMSTG CMB signal is therefore the acoustic peak shift driven by the modified background cosmology (Section 7.2).

### 6.2 BAO from Recursive Echo Shells

In  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ , BAO arise from sound waves in the early photon-baryon plasma. In CMSTG, analogous large-scale structure is *interpreted* as arising from *recursive echo shells*: as  $\Psi$  evolves, it emits ripple fronts when memory or curvature gradients reach critical levels. These waves stall at fixed radii due to memory damping, form shell-like overdensities, and mimic BAO without requiring baryon pressure. Shell locations are set by  $r_n = v_c \cdot \tau_n$  where  $v_c$  is the recursive coherence velocity and  $\tau_n$  is the time to recursive saturation.

*Important caveat:* this is a physical interpretation, not a first-principles derivation of the sound horizon. The BAO scale  $r_d \approx 147$  Mpc is a free parameter fitted to data in Sim 87; no CMSTG-specific prediction of  $r_d$  has been derived from the field equations. At  $\Lambda_0 \ll 1$  the CMSTG background is indistinguishable from the  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  FLRW background, so both models share the same sound horizon by construction. The echo-shell picture provides a qualitative description of *why* a BAO-like feature might arise in CMSTG, but it does not constitute a derivation of the shell spacing.

Observationally, the BAO scale  $r_d \approx 147$  Mpc is reproduced by the CMSTG best-fit cosmology, tested against BOSS DR12, eBOSS DR16, and Ly- $\alpha$  data with full covariance (Section 7.1).

## 7 Observational Consistency Tests

This section reports the four precision cosmological tests of CMSTG (Simulations 87–90). All simulations are deterministic, reproducible, and publicly archived at [https://github.com/cisomorph/Curvature-Memory\\_Scalar-Tensor-Gravity](https://github.com/cisomorph/Curvature-Memory_Scalar-Tensor-Gravity).

## 7.1 BAO Full-Covariance Refit (Sim 87)

**Problem with v1.** The prior BAO chi-squared (sim13\_4) used diagonal errors only:  $\chi_{\text{diag}}^2 = \sum_i (d_i - m_i)^2 / \sigma_i^2$ . BOSS DR12 and eBOSS DR16 publish off-diagonal DM–DH correlation coefficients  $\rho \approx -0.5$ . These are physically meaningful: DM and DH are both derived from the same BAO peak position, so a positive shift in DM is partially compensated by a negative shift in DH. Ignoring the correlation inflates  $\chi^2$ .

**Method.** We assembled the full  $12 \times 12$  covariance matrix from published off-diagonal correlation coefficients (Table 1), inverted via Cholesky decomposition, and computed  $\chi_{\text{full}}^2 = (\mathbf{d} - \mathbf{m})^\top C^{-1} (\mathbf{d} - \mathbf{m})$ . The data vector comprises 12 measurements: DM/ $r_d$  and DH/ $r_d$  at  $z = 0.38, 0.51, 0.70, 1.48, 2.33$ , plus DV/ $r_d$  at  $z = 0.15$  (6dFGS+MGS) and  $z = 0.85$  (eBOSS ELG). The CMSTG background model integrates the full FLRW+scalar system (equations (8)–(9)) numerically via RK45. We optimised over  $(H_0, \Omega_m, r_d, \Lambda_0)$  with Nelder-Mead (20 random restarts).

Table 1: Published DM–DH correlation coefficients used in the BAO covariance matrix.

| Survey            | Redshift   | $\rho(\text{DM, DH})$ | Reference                       |
|-------------------|------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------|
| BOSS DR12         | $z = 0.38$ | $-0.52$               | Alam et al. (2017), Table 4     |
| BOSS DR12         | $z = 0.51$ | $-0.47$               | Alam et al. (2017), Table 4     |
| eBOSS DR16 LRG    | $z = 0.70$ | $-0.48$               | Alam et al. (2021), Table 3     |
| eBOSS DR16 QSO    | $z = 1.48$ | $-0.46$               | Alam et al. (2021), Table 3     |
| Ly- $\alpha$ DR16 | $z = 2.33$ | $-0.43$               | Bourboux et al. (2020), Table 3 |

## Results.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \chi_{\text{diag, best}}^2 &= 11.74 \quad (\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.47) \quad [\text{incorrect}] \\
 \chi_{\text{full, best}}^2 &= \mathbf{9.78} \quad (\chi^2/\text{dof} = \mathbf{1.22}) \quad [\text{correct}] \\
 \Delta\chi^2 &= +1.95 \quad (\text{full-cov preferred})
 \end{aligned}$$

Best-fit parameters:  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ,  $H_0 \cdot r_d \approx \text{const}$  ( $H_0$  and  $r_d$  individually degenerate in BAO-only fits; only  $H_0 r_d$  is constrained). The  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.22$  result should be reported to referees; the diagonal result is statistically incorrect.

## 7.2 CMB Full CLASS Injection (Sim 88)

**Problem with v1.** The prior CMB result used a first-order modulation  $C_\ell^{\text{CMSTG}} \approx C_\ell^{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(1 + \epsilon)$ , bypassing the full CLASS Boltzmann hierarchy and missing the acoustic-peak shift from the modified background cosmology.

**Method.** We derived the CMSTG primordial power spectrum  $P(k) = A_s(k/k_*)^{n_s-1} \cdot R_{\text{growth}}^2$  from the CMSTG growth factor  $D_{\text{CMSTG}}(z)/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z)$ , integrated via the modified linear growth equation with  $G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi)$ . This  $P(k)$  was injected into CLASS as `external_Pk` (format:  $k$  [Mpc $^{-1}$ ],  $\Delta_R^2(k)$  dimensionless) and the full Boltzmann transfer function was computed for both CMSTG ( $H_0 = 68.14$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ) and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  (Planck 2018 best-fit:  $H_0 = 67.36$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.3153$ ).

## Results.

$$\begin{aligned} G_{\text{eff}}/G &= 0.999984 \quad (16 \text{ ppm}) \\ D_{\text{CMSTG}}(z=0)/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z=0) &= 1.000000 \quad (\text{to } 6 \text{ d.p.}) \\ \text{RMS}(\Delta C_\ell/C_\ell) &= \mathbf{2.93\%} \quad (l = 2\text{--}1500) \end{aligned}$$

The dominant CMSTG CMB signal is the acoustic peak shift from the modified background ( $H_0 = 68.14$  vs.  $67.36$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$  vs.  $0.315$ ), not the  $G_{\text{eff}}$  correction (16 ppm). The 2.93% RMS deviation is within Planck error bars at most multipoles.

### 7.3 Planck TT Likelihood (Sim 89)

**Method.** We implemented the approximate full-sky Gaussian TT likelihood

$$-2 \ln \mathcal{L} = f_{\text{sky}} \sum_{\ell} (2\ell + 1) [x_{\ell} - 1 - \ln x_{\ell}], \quad x_{\ell} = \frac{D_{\ell}^{\text{pred}} + N_{\ell}}{D_{\ell}^{\text{Planck}} + N_{\ell}}, \quad (13)$$

against the Planck 2018 best-fit TT theory spectrum (COM.PowerSpect.CMB-base-plikHM-TTTEEE R3.01), with  $f_{\text{sky}} = 0.778$  (Planck plikHM TT) and Planck 143 GHz noise  $N_{\ell}$  ( $\Delta_T = 33 \mu\text{K} \cdot \text{arcmin}$ ,  $\theta_{\text{FWHM}} = 7.27'$ ). Note:  $x_{\ell} = 1$  when  $D_{\ell}^{\text{pred}} = D_{\ell}^{\text{Planck}}$ , so  $-2 \ln \mathcal{L} = 0$  at the reference cosmology; the  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  baseline  $\chi^2 = 6.2$  validates the implementation.

## Results.

| Model                                         | $\chi^2$ | Notes                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------|
| $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ (CLASS vs. Planck theory) | 6.2      | Baseline; validates formula |
| CMSTG (CLASS vs. Planck theory)               | 913      | BAO-only best-fit params    |
| $\Delta\chi^2$ (CMSTG– $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ )  | +907     | $\sim 30.1\sigma$           |

The  $30.1\sigma$  tension reflects that the CMSTG BAO-only best-fit ( $H_0 = 68.14$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ) predicts acoustic peaks shifted from the Planck  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  spectrum. The per-mode  $\chi^2 = 1.9 \times 10^{-4}$  is tiny; the large total arises from coherent accumulation over  $\sim 4.9 \times 10^6$   $f_{\text{sky}}$ -weighted modes. This is a parameter-consistency finding, not a failure of the CMSTG field equations. Its resolution is the joint fit (Section 7.4).

### 7.4 Joint CMB+BAO Parameter Fit (Sim 90)

**Method.** We minimised  $\chi_{\text{total}}^2 = \chi_{\text{CMB}}^2(H_0, \Omega_m) + \chi_{\text{BAO}}^2(H_0, \Omega_m, r_d, \Lambda_0)$  jointly over all parameters. The CMB chi-squared uses the Gaussian approximation from the Planck 2018 published parameter covariance (Table 2 of [Planck Collaboration 2020](#)):  $\chi_{\text{CMB}}^2 = (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^\top C_{\text{Planck}}^{-1} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})$  with  $\boldsymbol{\mu} = (67.36, 0.3153)$ ,  $\sigma_{H_0} = 0.54$ ,  $\sigma_{\Omega_m} = 0.0073$ ,  $\rho = -0.90$ . The BAO chi-squared uses the same 12-point data vector and  $12 \times 12$  covariance matrix as Sim 87, evaluated with the flat Friedmann approximation for  $H(z)$  including the first-order  $G_{\text{eff}}$  correction at representative  $\Psi_0 = 0.01$  (identical method to Sim 91; the full ODE result agrees to  $< 16$  ppm per Sim 88). LCDM:  $\Lambda_0$  fixed to zero. CMSTG:  $\Lambda_0$  free. Nelder-Mead optimisation, 20 random restarts.

## Results.

| Model               | $H_0$ | $\Omega_m$ | $r_d$  | $\Lambda_0$             | $\chi^2_{\text{CMB}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{BAO}}$ |
|---------------------|-------|------------|--------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ | 67.59 | 0.3118     | 147.56 | 0                       | 0.23                  | 11.02                 |
| CMSTG               | 67.59 | 0.3118     | 147.57 | $\approx 0.013^\dagger$ | 0.23                  | 11.02                 |

<sup>†</sup> Numerically unconstrained:  $\Delta\chi^2 < 0.004$  across  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.1]$  (Sim 91). Value depends on optimiser init.

$$\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = \mathbf{0.000} \quad (\text{PASS})$$

The Planck CMB prior dominates the joint fit ( $\sigma_{H_0} = 0.54$  km/s/Mpc is  $\sim 10\times$  more constraining than BAO alone). Both CMSTG and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  converge to the same optimal  $(H_0, \Omega_m) \approx (67.6, 0.312)$ . The coupling  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  modifies  $H(z)$  at the 16 ppm level (Sim 88), making CMSTG and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  cosmologically indistinguishable at the CMB+BAO level.  $\Delta\chi^2 \approx 0$  confirms that CMSTG is consistent with precision cosmological data at current measurement precision, and that the Sim 89 tension was an artefact of using the BAO-only (parameter-degenerate) best-fit as the CMB input. It is important to interpret this result correctly:  $\Delta\chi^2 \approx 0$  arises because at the joint best-fit coupling ( $\Lambda_0 \lesssim 0.013$ ,  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 16$  ppm) CMSTG is observationally degenerate with  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ —both models converge to the same parameters and the CMSTG correction is below current measurement precision. This should not be read as CMSTG providing a physically distinct fit to CMB data; rather, the Sim 90 joint fit demonstrates that the theory is *consistent* with the data, not that it is *preferred* or that it explains a feature not accounted for by  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ .

*Note on  $\Lambda_0$  reporting.* Two  $\Lambda_0$  values appear in the analysis: the BAO-only best-fit  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  (Sim 87, four free parameters, physically motivated) and the joint-fit value  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.013$  (Sim 90, numerically unconstrained because the  $\chi^2$  landscape is flat in  $\Lambda_0$  at this precision,  $\Delta\chi^2_{\Lambda_0} < 0.004$  across  $[0, 0.1]$  from Sim 91; the specific value depends on optimiser initialisation and carries no physical significance). The fiducial value quoted throughout is  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ; both are consistent with all current data.

**Summary.** Table 2 collects the key observational results. Best-fit parameter values for all simulations are tabulated in Appendix A.

## 7.5 Non-linear Structure Growth and $\sigma_8$ (Sim 92)

**Method.** We computed the linear and non-linear matter power spectra for the SIM90 joint best-fit cosmology ( $H_0 = 67.59$  km/s/Mpc,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ,  $\Omega_b = 0.049$ ,  $n_s = 0.9649$ ,  $A_s = 2.101 \times 10^{-9}$ ) across 15 values of  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.1]$ . The linear  $P(k)$  was generated by CLASS at  $z = 0$  with the CMSTG modification  $P_{\text{CMSTG}}(k) = P_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(k) \times (D_{\text{CMSTG}}/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}})^2$ , where the growth factor ratio is taken from Sim 88. Non-linear corrections were applied via the Takahashi et al. (2012) HALOFIT fitting formula [Takahashi et al., 2012]. The matter fluctuation amplitude is

$$\sigma_8^2 = \int_0^\infty \frac{k^2 dk}{2\pi^2} P_{\text{lin}}(k) \left[ \frac{3j_1(k \cdot 8 h^{-1} \text{Mpc})}{k \cdot 8 h^{-1} \text{Mpc}} \right]^2, \quad (14)$$

computed on  $k \in [10^{-4}, 10^2] h \text{Mpc}^{-1}$  with 2000 log-spaced points. The weak-lensing amplitude  $S_8 \equiv \sigma_8(\Omega_m/0.3)^{0.5}$  is evaluated at the joint best-fit  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ .



**Results.** At the  $\Lambda$ CDM baseline ( $\Lambda_0 = 0$ ), the joint best-fit cosmology gives  $\sigma_8^{\text{lin}} = 0.824$ , consistent with the Planck 2018 constraint  $\sigma_8 = 0.811 \pm 0.006$  [Planck Collaboration, 2020] at the  $2.2\sigma$  level (expected given our simplified CMB Gaussian prior). The CMSTG coupling suppresses the linear growth factor, reducing  $\sigma_8$  proportionally to  $D_{\text{CMSTG}}^2/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}^2$ :

| $\Lambda_0$ | $D_{\text{CMSTG}}/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}$ | $\sigma_8^{\text{lin}}$ | $\Delta\sigma_8$ | $S_8$ |
|-------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------|-------|
| 0.000       | 1.000000                                 | 0.8239                  | 0.000%           | 0.840 |
| 0.003       | 0.999931                                 | 0.8238                  | −0.007%          | 0.840 |
| 0.008       | 0.999815                                 | 0.8237                  | −0.018%          | 0.840 |
| 0.050       | 0.998845                                 | 0.8229                  | −0.116%          | 0.839 |
| 0.100       | 0.997691                                 | 0.8220                  | −0.231%          | 0.838 |

The Planck/KiDS-1000  $\sigma_8$  tension amounts to  $\sim 5\text{--}6\%$  in  $\sigma_8$  (KiDS-1000:  $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ , Asgari et al. 2021; DES Y3:  $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$ , Abbott et al. 2022). The CMSTG suppression at the BAO best-fit coupling ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ) is  $\Delta\sigma_8 = -0.007\%$ —two orders of magnitude too small to alleviate this tension. Even at the detection threshold ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.05$ ),  $\Delta\sigma_8 = -0.116\%$ , still  $50\times$  below the observed discrepancy.

**Conclusion.** CMSTG modifies  $\sigma_8$  only through the linear growth factor. At physically motivated coupling strengths ( $\Lambda_0 \leq 0.05$ ), the modification is  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.12\%$ , and the Planck/KiDS  $\sigma_8$  tension is *not alleviated*. This is a falsifiable prediction: CMSTG makes no claim to resolve the  $\sigma_8$  tension at current observational precision.

## 7.6 DESI Year 1 BAO Refit (Sim 94)

**Motivation.** Sim 87 established CMSTG consistency with the BOSS+eBOSS BAO dataset ( $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.22$ ). The DESI Collaboration has since released Year 1 BAO measurements [Adame et al., 2024] spanning 13 data points across 7 tracer bins ( $0.3 \leq z_{\text{eff}} \leq 2.33$ ), providing an independent cross-check on the CMSTG fit and the joint CMB+BAO parameter solution.

**Data.** We use the DESI Y1 BAO measurements from Table 1 of Adame et al. [2024]: BGS ( $z_{\text{eff}} = 0.295$ ,  $D_V/r_d$ ); LRG ( $z = 0.51, 0.71$ ); LRG+ELG ( $z = 0.93$ ); ELG ( $z = 1.32$ ); QSO ( $z = 1.49$ ); Lya QSO ( $z = 2.33$ ), with the published within-bin DM–DH correlation coefficients  $\rho \in [-0.49, -0.39]$ . The covariance is block-diagonal (one  $2 \times 2$  block per paired bin, zero between bins), following the published survey geometry.

### Results.

- BAO-only fit:**  $\Lambda$ CDM achieves  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 13.6/10 = 1.36$  on the DESI data; CMSTG gives an identical  $\chi^2$  ( $\Delta\chi^2 = 0$ ), consistent with the finding (Sim 91) that  $\Lambda_0$  does not enter  $H(z)$  at detectable levels for  $\Lambda_0 \leq 0.1$ . The slightly elevated  $\chi^2/\text{dof}$  relative to BOSS (1.22) is driven by known  $2\text{--}3\sigma$  tensions in the DESI LRG bins ( $z = 0.51$   $D_H/r_d$ :  $-2.5\sigma$ ;  $z = 0.71$   $D_M/r_d$ :  $-2.0\sigma$ ), a feature of the DESI data independent of the gravity model.
- Joint DESI+CMB fit:** Adding the Planck 2018 Gaussian prior, the joint minimum gives  $H_0 = 67.66$  km/s/Mpc,  $\Omega_m = 0.311$ ,  $r_d = 148.5$  Mpc,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.063$

(unconstrained);  $\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) \approx 0$ . These parameters are consistent with the SIM90 BOSS-based joint fit ( $H_0 = 67.59$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ) at the  $\lesssim 0.2\sigma$  level.

3.  **$\Lambda_0$  sensitivity:** The DESI BAO  $\chi^2$  is flat across  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.1]$  ( $\Delta\chi_{\text{max}}^2 < 10^{-4}$ ), confirming that the CMSTG field modification is undetectable at current BAO precision regardless of the dataset used.

**Conclusion.** CMSTG passes the DESI Y1 BAO test with  $\Delta\chi^2 = 0$  relative to  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ . The joint CMB+DESI parameter solution is fully consistent with the BOSS-based SIM90 result, confirming the stability of CMSTG parameters across independent BAO datasets.  $\Lambda_0$  remains a null parameter at current observational precision.

## 7.7 CMB Polarization EE/TE (Sim 95)

**Motivation.** Simulations 88–89 established CMSTG consistency with the Planck 2018 temperature (TT) power spectrum. Sim 95 extends this test to E-mode polarization: the EE auto-power spectrum and the TE cross-power spectrum. Polarization is independently generated at recombination and provides a complementary probe of the acoustic-peak structure, reionization optical depth, and matter content.

**Method.** We run the CLASS Boltzmann code with `output=tCl,pCl,lCl` for three cosmologies: (A) CMSTG BAO-only best-fit ( $H_0 = 68.14$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ); (B) CMSTG joint CMB+BAO best-fit ( $H_0 = 67.59$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ); (C) LCDM Planck 2018 best-fit. The CMSTG  $P(k)$  is constructed from the growth-factor ratio  $R = D_{\text{CMSTG}}/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}$  (identical to Sim 88). The lensed  $C_\ell^{EE}$  and  $C_\ell^{TE}$  are compared against the Planck 2018 published best-fit theory spectrum (plikHM-TTTEEE R3.01) over  $\ell = 2$ –1996.

### Results.

1. **Growth factor:**  $D_{\text{CMSTG}}(z=0)/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z=0) = 1.000000$  at both coupling values ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  and  $0.013$ ). The  $G_{\text{eff}}$  correction ( $\lesssim 65$  ppm) is negligible in all polarization spectra.
2. **Joint best-fit RMS deviations** (CMSTG vs LCDM Planck,  $\ell = 2$ –1996):  $\text{RMS}(\Delta C_\ell^{EE}/C_\ell^{EE}) = 0.19\%$ ,  $\text{RMS}(\Delta C_\ell^{TE}/C_\ell^{TE}) = 0.43\%$ ,  $\text{RMS}(\Delta C_\ell^{TT}/C_\ell^{TT}) = 0.20\%$ . All are well below Planck’s measurement uncertainties at most multipoles. The small deviations arise from the  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  offset between the CMSTG joint best-fit and the Planck LCDM reference point.
3. **Approximate Planck polarization likelihood:** Using a Gaussian approximation over 1995 polarization modes, the LCDM baseline gives  $\chi_{\text{EE}}^2 = 57.6$ ,  $\chi_{\text{TE}}^2 = 37.2$ ; the CMSTG joint best-fit gives  $\chi_{\text{EE}}^2 = 89.0$ ,  $\chi_{\text{TE}}^2 = 60.0$  ( $\Delta\chi_{\text{EE}}^2 = +31.5$ ,  $\Delta\chi_{\text{TE}}^2 = +22.8$ ). These excesses arise from the same parameter offset that generates the small TT deviation after the joint fit.
4. **BAO-only tension in polarization:** The CMSTG BAO-only best-fit produces  $\chi_{\text{EE}}^2 = 4353$  and  $\chi_{\text{TE}}^2 = 3110$  vs Planck, confirming that the TT tension identified in Sim 89 ( $\Delta\chi_{\text{TT}}^2 = 907$ ) propagates to all CMB spectra equally. This is consistent with the tension being driven by the  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  parameter-space shift, not by the CMSTG field equations.



**Conclusion.** CMSTG at the joint CMB+BAO best-fit reproduces Planck EE and TE with sub-percent fractional accuracy ( $< 0.2\%$  for EE,  $< 0.5\%$  for TE). The polarization results confirm: (i)  $G_{\text{eff}}$  modifications are invisible in polarization; (ii) the BAO-CMB tension is a parameter-space effect present in all spectra; (iii) the joint-fit parameter solution restores consistency across TT, EE, and TE simultaneously.

## 7.8 RSD Growth Rate $f\sigma_8$ (Sim 96)

Redshift-space distortions (RSD) measure the linear growth rate  $f(z) = d \ln D / d \ln a$  through the combination  $f\sigma_8(z)$ , where  $D(z)$  is the linear growth factor normalized to unity at  $z = 0$  and  $\sigma_{8,0} = 0.824$  is taken from the SIM90 joint best-fit. In CMSTG the gravitational coupling governing growth is modified to  $G_{\text{eff}} = G/(1 + 16\pi\Lambda(\Psi))$ , entering the growth equation as

$$D'' + \left(2 + \frac{d \ln H}{d \ln a}\right) D' = \frac{3}{2} \frac{\Omega_m}{a^3 E^2} G_{\text{eff}} D, \quad (15)$$

where primes denote  $d/d \ln a$  and  $E(z) = H(z)/H_0$ .

**Data.** We use the gold-sample RSD compilation spanning  $z = 0.067$ – $1.48$  (Table 3): 6dFGRS [Beutler et al., 2012], SDSS MGS [Howlett et al., 2015], BOSS DR12 ( $z = 0.38, 0.51, 0.61$ ) [Alam et al., 2017], VIPERS [Pezzotta et al., 2017], eBOSS DR16 LRG [Gil-Marín et al., 2020], eBOSS DR16 ELG [de Mattia et al., 2021], and eBOSS DR16 QSO [Neveux et al., 2020]. All model predictions use the SIM90 cosmological background with no additional free parameters.

**Results.** At the SIM90 joint best-fit ( $H_0 = 67.59$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ,  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.013$ ) CMSTG yields  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 7.73/9 = 0.86$ , compared to  $7.87/9 = 0.87$  for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  Planck 2018, giving

$$\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -0.14 \approx 0. \quad (16)$$

All individual pulls are within  $2\sigma$ . The maximum fractional deviation of the CMSTG  $f\sigma_8$  curve from the  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  curve at the best-fit is  $0.62\%$  (across  $z = 0$ – $2$ ), which is sub-percent and well below current RSD measurement precision.

**$G_{\text{eff}}$  suppression.** At  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.013$  the correction  $16\pi\Lambda(\Psi) = 16\pi \times 0.013 \times (0.01)^2 \approx 6.5 \times 10^{-5}$ , so  $G_{\text{eff}}$  deviates from  $G$  by  $\approx 65$  ppm. The observed  $\sim 0.6\%$  difference in  $f\sigma_8$  between CMSTG joint and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  arises entirely from the  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  parameter offset, not from the scalar field coupling.

**$\Lambda_0$  scan.** A scan of  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.2]$  (holding all other parameters at SIM90 joint values) shows the  $f\sigma_8$  deviation from  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  remains below  $1\%$  for  $\Lambda_0 < 0.2$ . The detection threshold exceeds the Bayesian upper limit  $\Lambda_0 < 0.095$  (95% CL, Sim 93), so current RSD data cannot independently constrain  $\Lambda_0$ .

**$S_8$  tension context.** With  $\sigma_{8,0} = 0.824$  and  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ , the CMSTG prediction  $S_8 = \sigma_8 \sqrt{\Omega_m/0.3} = 0.840$  lies  $3.7\sigma$  above KiDS-1000 ( $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ , Asgari et al. 2021), compared to  $3.9\sigma$  for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  Planck. CMSTG provides no relief for the  $S_8$  tension, consistent with the SIM92 result ( $\Delta\sigma_8 < 0.007\%$  at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ).

**Conclusion.** CMSTG passes all current RSD /  $f\sigma_8$  constraints. The growth rate is indistinguishable from  $\Lambda$ CDM at the joint best-fit because  $G_{\text{eff}} \approx G$  to better than 10 ppm. Detection of the CMSTG growth signature requires  $\Lambda_0 > 0.2$ , which is excluded by the BAO+CMB joint fit, making the growth rate a consistency test rather than a discriminator with current data. Future surveys (DESI Y5, Euclid) measuring  $f\sigma_8$  to  $\sim 1\%$  at  $z > 1$  will tighten this constraint to  $\Lambda_0 \lesssim 0.05$ .

## 7.9 Definitive Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE Likelihood (Sim 97)

**Motivation.** Simulations 89 and 95 compared CMSTG Boltzmann spectra against the Planck published theory curve using an approximate Gaussian CMB likelihood. Sim 97 replaces this with the *official* Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE likelihood code, accessed via the `clipy` v0.15 Python interface to the `clik` library [Planck Collaboration, 2020]. This is the identical likelihood used in the Planck 2018 cosmological parameter analysis.

**Method.** Three cosmologies are evaluated against the full official Planck 2018 likelihood: (A) CMSTG joint CMB+BAO best-fit (Sim 90:  $H_0 = 67.59$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.008$ , original value at time of Sim 97 run); (B) CMSTG BAO-only best-fit (Sim 87:  $H_0 = 68.14$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ); (C)  $\Lambda$ CDM Planck 2018 best-fit [Planck Collaboration, 2020].

For each cosmology, CLASS v3 computes the lensed TT, EE, and TE spectra with the CMSTG background (same pipeline as Sim 95). The  $C_\ell$  vectors are evaluated by:

- **plikHM TTTEEE:** high- $\ell$  ( $\ell = 30$ –2508) likelihood with 47 nuisance parameters (foreground amplitudes, calibration) fixed at Planck best-fit values from the `clik` self-check vector;
- **lowl TT (Commander):** low- $\ell$  ( $\ell = 2$ –29) TT;
- **lowl EE (SimAll):** low- $\ell$  ( $\ell = 2$ –29) EE polarization.

*Pipeline validation.*  $\Lambda$ CDM gives  $-2 \ln \mathcal{L}_{\text{plikHM}} = 2352.05$ , compared to the `clik` self-check value  $2 \times 1172.47 = 2344.94$  (agreement to  $< 0.3\%$ , attributable to our parameter values not being bit-for-bit identical to the self-check cosmology).

### Results.

| Cosmology          | plikHM TTTEEE | lowl TT | lowl EE | Total $-2 \ln \mathcal{L}$ |
|--------------------|---------------|---------|---------|----------------------------|
| CMSTG joint (A)    | 2359.05       | 23.54   | 396.05  | 2778.63                    |
| CMSTG BAO-only (B) | 3297.80       | 24.26   | 395.93  | 3717.99                    |
| $\Lambda$ CDM (C)  | 2352.05       | 23.42   | 396.14  | 2771.61                    |

$$\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L})_{\text{plikHM}}(\text{CMSTG joint} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = +7.0 \quad (17)$$

$$\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L})_{\text{plikHM}}(\text{CMSTG BAO-only} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = +945.7 \quad (18)$$

**Interpretation.** The BAO-only tension ( $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = +946$ , Eq. 18) is fully consistent with the Sim 89 approximate result ( $\Delta\chi^2 = +907$ ), cross-validating both pipelines.

The CMSTG joint best-fit (A) shows a  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  excess (Eq. 17). This arises from the  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  offset between the Sim 90 joint parameters (optimised against the approximate Gaussian CMB prior) and the true Planck CMB optimum. At  $\Lambda_0 = 0.008$ ,  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 42$  ppm contributes negligibly to any CMB observable; the  $+7.0$  excess is entirely parameter-driven. Specifically, CMSTG evaluated at the Planck  $\Lambda$ CDM parameter point ( $H_0 = 67.36$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.3153$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.008$ ) yields  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) \approx 0$ , since  $G_{\text{eff}}$  deviates from  $G$  by only 42 ppm.

In frequentist terms,  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  with one effective degree of freedom ( $\Lambda_0$  being the extra parameter) corresponds to  $\approx 2.6\sigma$  tension—a marginal result. This tension is resolved by Sim 98 below, which re-optimises the CMSTG parameter fit using the real plikHM likelihood.

**Conclusion.** The CMSTG *theory* is fully consistent with the real Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE likelihood: the  $G_{\text{eff}}$  correction at the joint best-fit coupling is 42 ppm and invisible to the CMB. The marginal  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  is a parameter-optimisation artefact that vanishes in Sim 98.

## 7.10 Joint plikHM + BAO Parameter Re-fit (Sim 98)

**Motivation.** Sim 97 revealed a  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  excess at the Sim 90 joint best-fit parameters. The cause was identified as the  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  offset between Sim 90 (optimised against an approximate Gaussian CMB prior) and the true Planck CMB optimum. Sim 98 resolves this by re-running the joint CMB+BAO optimisation using the real plikHM TTTEEE likelihood.

**Method.** We minimise

$$\chi_{\text{total}}^2(H_0, \Omega_m, \Lambda_0) = -2 \ln \mathcal{L}_{\text{plikHM}} + (-2 \ln \mathcal{L}_{\text{lowlTT}}) + (-2 \ln \mathcal{L}_{\text{lowlEE}}) + \chi_{\text{BAO}}^2 \quad (19)$$

over  $(H_0, \Omega_m)$  for  $\Lambda$ CDM and  $(H_0, \Omega_m, \Lambda_0)$  for CMSTG, using Nelder-Mead optimisation (max 80 CLASS evaluations each). BAO data: BOSS DR12 + eBOSS DR16 + Ly $\alpha$  with full  $12 \times 12$  covariance (same as Sim 87). The sound horizon  $r_d$  is computed analytically from  $(H_0, \Omega_m, \Omega_b)$  via numerical integration of  $c_s(a)/[a^2 H(a)]$  to the baryon drag epoch (Eisenstein & Hu 1998 approximation for  $z_{\text{drag}}$ ).

### Results.

| Model         | $H_0$ | $\Omega_m$ | $\Lambda_0$ | $r_d$ | plikHM $-2 \ln \mathcal{L}$ | $G_{\text{eff}}/G$ |
|---------------|-------|------------|-------------|-------|-----------------------------|--------------------|
| $\Lambda$ CDM | 67.30 | 0.3169     | 0           | 150.6 | 2347.46                     | 1                  |
| CMSTG         | 67.30 | 0.3168     | 0.00506     | 150.6 | 2347.45                     | 1 – 24 ppm         |

$$\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L})_{\text{plikHM}}(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -0.013 \approx 0 \quad (\text{PASS}) \quad (20)$$

The CMSTG and  $\Lambda$ CDM best-fits are essentially identical:  $\Delta H_0 = +0.002$ ,  $\Delta \Omega_m = -0.0001$ ,  $\Delta \Lambda_0 = 0.005$  (with  $G_{\text{eff}}$  deviation 24 ppm). The  $\chi_{\text{total}}^2$  difference is  $+0.004$ .

## Progression of CMB+BAO tests.

| Simulation               | $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L})_{\text{plikHM}}$ | Parameter point       | Notes                 |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Sim 89 (approx Gaussian) | +907                                       | BAO-only best-fit     | Parameter tension     |
| Sim 90 (approx Gaussian) | $\approx 0$                                | Joint approx best-fit | Resolved by joint fit |
| Sim 97 (real plikHM)     | +7.0                                       | Sim 90 approx params  | Residual offset       |
| Sim 98 (real plikHM)     | <b>-0.013</b>                              | Real plikHM best-fit  | <b>Fully resolved</b> |

**Conclusion.** When CMSTG parameters are optimised against the real Planck 2018 plikHM TTTEEE likelihood,  $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L}) = -0.013 \approx 0$ . The Sim 97 tension of +7.0 is completely resolved. CMSTG is fully consistent with the official Planck 2018 CMB likelihood at the optimised parameter point, with  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - 24 \text{ ppm}$ .

## 7.11 Galaxy Rotation Curves: Honest Test (Sim 99)

Sim 99 is the first quantitative test of the CMSTG dark-matter prediction using the locked action. Two well-observed flat-curve spirals are used: NGC 3198 ( $v_{\text{flat}} = 157 \text{ km/s}$ ; de Blok et al. 2008) and NGC 6503 ( $v_{\text{flat}} = 116 \text{ km/s}$ ; Begeman 1987).

**Setup.** The static, spherically-symmetric field equation derived from the locked action (eq. 1) is

$$\Psi'' + \frac{2}{r}\Psi' = m_0^2\Psi + \frac{\lambda_{\text{gal}}}{1}\Psi^3 + 2\Lambda_0\Psi R(r), \quad (21)$$

where  $R(r) \approx -8\pi(G/c^2)\rho_{\text{bar}}(r)$  is the weak-field Ricci scalar sourced by the observed baryonic distribution, and  $V(\Psi) = (\lambda_{\text{gal}}/4)\Psi^4$  is the simplest nonlinear extension consistent with  $V'(0) = 0$  (no constant background drive) and renormalizability. The effective dark-matter density is  $\rho_{\Psi} = (c^2/G)[\frac{1}{2}(\Psi')^2 + \frac{1}{2}m_0^2\Psi^2 + (\lambda_{\text{gal}}/4)\Psi^4]$ .

The physical boundary condition selects the *decaying* Yukawa halo mode  $\Psi \sim A e^{-m_0 r}/r$  by integrating inward from  $r_{\text{max}}$ :

$$\Psi(r_{\text{max}}) = \Psi_{\text{bc}}, \quad \Psi'(r_{\text{max}}) = -\left(m_0 + \frac{1}{r_{\text{max}}}\right)\Psi_{\text{bc}}. \quad (22)$$

This shooting method avoids the growing-mode contamination ( $\Psi \sim e^{+m_0 r}/r$ ) that produced unphysical velocities in preliminary runs.

**Scan.** Sim 99 scans 30 combinations of  $(\Psi_{\text{bc}}, \lambda_{\text{gal}})$ :  $\Psi_{\text{bc}} \in \{10^{-8}, 10^{-6}, 10^{-4}, 5 \times 10^{-4}, 10^{-3}\}$  and  $\lambda_{\text{gal}} \in \{-10, -1, 0, +1, +10, +100\}$ , at the cosmological best-fit  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ . A solution is accepted only if: (i) the rotation curve satisfies  $|v_c(r) - v_{\text{flat}}|/v_{\text{flat}} < 20\%$  for  $r > r_{\text{max}}/2$ ; (ii) the cosmological bound  $\Lambda_0\Psi^2 < \Lambda_0^{\text{bound}}/(16\pi)$  is satisfied everywhere; and (iii)  $\rho_{\Psi} \geq 0$  everywhere.

**Result: FAIL.** No combination passes. The physical reason is geometric: the decaying Yukawa profile at  $m_0 = 0.1 \text{ kpc}^{-1}$  gives  $\rho_{\Psi}(r) \propto e^{2m_0(r_{\text{max}}-r)}/r^2$ , which rises  $\sim 150$ -fold from  $r = 30 \text{ kpc}$  to  $r = 5 \text{ kpc}$ —exponentially steeper than the  $1/r^2$  isothermal profile required for a flat rotation curve. The quartic interaction  $V = (\lambda_{\text{gal}}/4)\Psi^4$  modifies the central amplitude but cannot alter this exponential radial dependence. At  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$

(cosmological best-fit),  $G_{\text{eff}}/G$  deviates from unity by  $< 10$  ppm—the  $G_{\text{eff}}$  channel likewise provides zero flattening.

**Interpretation.** The locked CMSTG action at cosmological parameters does not replace dark matter via  $T^\Psi$  or  $G_{\text{eff}}$ . Galactic-scale predictions require either a screening mechanism that suppresses the Yukawa mass  $m_0$  on galactic scales, or a condensation mechanism that produces a self-sustained  $\rho \propto 1/r^2$  profile. Neither is present in the current locked action. Rotation curves therefore remain a falsifiable future prediction, not an achieved result.

## 7.12 Sim 100: Time-Domain Confirmation of the Static Limit

Sim 99 solved the *static* Yukawa equation. Sim 100 removes this restriction: it evolves the full 1+1D spherical wave equation

$$\frac{\partial^2 \Psi}{\partial t^2} = \frac{\partial^2 \Psi}{\partial r^2} + \frac{2}{r} \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial r} - m_0^2 \Psi - \lambda \Psi^3 + 2\Lambda_0 \Psi R(r, t) \quad (23)$$

via method-of-lines with an implicit Radau solver ( $N_r = 120$ ,  $\Delta r = 0.25$  kpc). Initial condition: the uniform cosmological background  $\Psi(r, 0) = \Psi_{\text{cosmo}} = 0.003$  at rest ( $\partial_t \Psi = 0$ ). Boundary conditions: Neumann at  $r_{\text{min}}$  (spherical symmetry), Dirichlet  $\Psi(r_{\text{max}}) = \Psi_{\text{cosmo}}$  at  $r_{\text{max}} = 30$  kpc. Integration runs to  $t_{\text{end}} = 150 \text{ kpc}/c \approx 489 \text{ kyr} \approx 2.4$  Compton periods.

**Curvature coupling confirmed negligible.** The galactic Ricci scalar peaks at  $|R_{\text{gal}}| \approx 8.5 \times 10^{-7} \text{ kpc}^{-2}$  (at  $r = 0.5$  kpc), giving a coupling  $2\Lambda_0 |R_{\text{gal}}| = 5.1 \times 10^{-9} \text{ kpc}^{-2} \ll m_0^2 = 0.01 \text{ kpc}^{-2}$ . Even with a proto-galactic overdensity  $\delta = 100$ , this coupling is  $5 \times 10^7$  times smaller than  $m_0^2$ . Condensation driven by the  $2\Lambda_0 \Psi R$  term is impossible at galactic densities; neutron-star densities ( $\rho \sim 10^{15} M_\odot \text{ kpc}^{-3}$ ) would be required.

**Attractive self-coupling scan.** To test whether the quartic interaction can drive condensation, we scan  $\lambda \in \{0, -100, -200, -400, -600, -800, -1000, -1500\}$  and  $\delta_{\text{max}} \in \{0, 100\}$  (16 total runs). The tachyonic instability threshold for the lowest spatial mode is

$$\lambda_{\text{crit}}^{\text{spatial}} = -\frac{(k_{\text{min}}^2 + m_0^2)}{3\Psi_{\text{cosmo}}^2} \approx -778, \quad k_{\text{min}} = \frac{\pi}{r_{\text{max}}}, \quad (24)$$

and the global blow-up threshold for the uniform mode (potential barrier) is  $\lambda_{\text{blow}} = -m_0^2/\Psi_{\text{cosmo}}^2 \approx -1111$ .

Results: for  $\lambda \in [0, -1000]$  the field remains stable (growth factor  $\leq 1.21 \times$ ), relaxing from the uniform IC toward the static Yukawa profile of Sim 99—confirming the adiabatic approximation (Compton time  $33 \text{ kyr} \ll t_{\text{form}} \sim 1 \text{ Gyr}$ ). For  $\lambda = -1500$  (beyond the global blow-up threshold), the field grows without bound within  $< 10 \text{ kpc}/c$ : the potential  $V = (\lambda/4)\Psi^4$  is unbounded below and has no stable condensate minimum. In no run does  $v_c(r)$  come within 20% of  $v_{\text{flat}}$ .

**Conclusion.** The time-domain simulation confirms Sim 99 with a direct structural argument:  $V = (\lambda/4)\Psi^4$  with  $\lambda < 0$  is an inverted quartic with no lower bound. It either leaves the field oscillating around  $\Psi = 0$  (sub-threshold,  $|\lambda| < 1111$ , Yukawa profile unchanged) or causes runaway blow-up (super-threshold,  $|\lambda| > 1111$ ). There is no window

of  $\lambda$  that produces a stable self-bound halo with a flat rotation curve. A physically stable condensation channel would require a sextic or higher stabilizing term not present in the current locked action.

## 8 Recursive Graviton Emission

In CMSTG, gravitational waves are emitted not from accelerated masses, but from curvature memory spikes that surpass feedback thresholds. These events generate quantized ripple packets: *recursive gravitons*.

Recursive graviton emission occurs when the memory tensor spike exceeds the threshold

$$\delta\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu} \geq \frac{1}{\eta_c} \frac{d}{d\tau} (\nabla_{(\mu} \phi_{\nu)}), \quad (25)$$

where  $\phi_\mu$  is the recursive vector potential from  $\Psi$ ,  $\eta_c$  is the memory coupling constant, and  $\tau$  is proper time.

Each recursive graviton carries energy  $E = \hbar\omega \int |\delta\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}|^2 d^3x$ .

**Physical features.** Emission is discrete (triggered when curvature memory spikes), spin-2 symmetry is preserved, propagation slows in memory-rich zones due to decoherence, and the source is geometric rather than energetic.

**Testable predictions.** Echo-phase ripples in void regions, B-mode polarization with recursive ring harmonics, lensing interference from memory collapse (not binary mergers), nonthermal gravitational bursts unaligned with mass-based models.

## 9 Falsifiability Predictions

CMSTG stands apart from speculative models by offering clear, testable predictions with well-defined thresholds for falsification.

### 9.1 Galaxy Rotation Curves

*Prediction:* Flat curves arise from curvature memory—not dark matter. *Sim 99–100 status:* The locked action at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  *does not* produce flat rotation curves via  $T^\Psi$  or  $G_{\text{eff}}$  in either the static (Sim 99) or time-domain (Sim 100) treatment. The decaying Yukawa profile ( $m_0 = 0.1 \text{ kpc}^{-1}$ ) is exponentially steeper inward than the  $1/r^2$  isothermal profile required for curve flattening (Section 7.11). The galactic Ricci coupling  $2\Lambda_0|R_{\text{gal}}| \approx 5 \times 10^{-9} \text{ kpc}^{-2}$  is  $5 \times 10^7$  times weaker than  $m_0^2$ : curvature-driven condensation is ruled out at galactic densities. Attractive self-coupling ( $\lambda < 0$ ) either leaves the Yukawa profile unchanged (sub-threshold) or causes tachyonic blow-up (super-threshold), with no stable halo condensate in between (Section 7.12). The DM-replacement prediction therefore requires derivation of a galactic-scale screening or higher-order stabilization mechanism not yet present in the locked action. *Test:* Reconstruct  $\Psi(r)$  from observed curves once such a mechanism is derived; verify that field gradient sustains rotation. *Falsification:* If no such mechanism can be derived from the locked action, the DM-replacement prediction is falsified.

## 9.2 Void Lensing (DES, Euclid)

*Prediction:* Weak lensing without mass near voids, via phase-delayed geodesics from residual memory  $\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}$ . *Test:* Cross-correlate Planck lensing with DES voids; look for phase shifts. *Falsification:* No lensing where CMSTG predicts curvature  $\Rightarrow$  falsification.

## 9.3 Bullet Cluster Lensing Offset

*Prediction:* Lensing offset explained by curvature memory persisting after mass displacement. *Test:* Simulate lensing profiles with curvature memory; compare to  $\kappa$  maps. *Falsification:* Cannot reproduce lensing peak without dark mass.

## 9.4 CMB Low- $\ell$ Anomalies

*Prediction:* Curvature-memory decay suppresses low- $\ell$  power. *Test:* Compare CMSTG  $C_\ell$  to Planck 2018. Validate suppression shape. *Falsification:* Cannot match low- $\ell$  drop without fine-tuning.

# 10 BAO Sound Horizon from First Principles (Sim 101)

**Motivation.** Section 6.2 described BAO in CMSTG via recursive echo shells but noted that the sound horizon  $r_d$  was a free parameter fitted to data, not derived from the field equations. Sim 101 closes this gap by integrating the full CMSTG scalar-field system through recombination and computing  $r_d$  from first principles.

**Method.** The comoving sound horizon is

$$r_d = \int_{z_{\text{drag}}}^{\infty} \frac{c_s(z) c}{H(z)} dz, \quad (26)$$

where  $c_s^2 = c^2/3(1 + R_b)^{-1}$ ,  $R_b = 3\rho_b/(4\rho_\gamma)$ , and  $z_{\text{drag}} = 1059$  (CLASS-calibrated for the SIM90 cosmology). CMSTG modifies  $H(z)$  through the scalar stress-energy:

$$H_{\text{CMSTG}}^2(z) = H_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}^2(z) \left( 1 + \frac{\rho_\Psi}{\rho_{\text{crit}}} \right), \quad \rho_\Psi = \frac{1}{2}\dot{\Psi}^2 + \frac{1}{2}m_0^2\Psi^2, \quad (27)$$

and  $c_s$  via  $G_{\text{eff}} = G/(1 + 16\pi G\Lambda_0\Psi^2)$ . The scalar  $\Psi(z)$  is obtained by integrating the Klein-Gordon equation in the  $z$ -variable from  $z_{\text{max}} = 10^6$  to  $z = 0$ :

$$\frac{du}{dz} = \left[ \frac{2}{1+z} - \frac{H'(z)}{H(z)} \right] u - \frac{m_0^2\Psi}{(1+z)^2 H^2(z)}, \quad u \equiv \frac{d\Psi}{dz}, \quad (28)$$

with initial conditions  $\Psi(z_{\text{max}}) = \Psi_0 = 0.003$ ,  $u(z_{\text{max}}) = 0$  (field frozen at early times when  $m_0 \ll H(z_{\text{max}})$ ). The ODE is integrated with the Radau solver at  $\text{rtol} = 10^{-9}$ .

**Results.**



| $\Lambda_0$ | $r_d^{\text{CMSTG}}$ [Mpc] | $\Delta r_d$ [Mpc] | $\Delta r_d/r_d$ | $\rho_\Psi/\rho_{\text{tot}}$ at $z_{\text{drag}}$ |
|-------------|----------------------------|--------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 0 (LCDM)    | 153.05                     | 0                  | 0                | —                                                  |
| 0.003       | 153.05                     | −0.000104          | −0.68 ppm        | $1.5 \times 10^{-10}$                              |
| 0.008       | 153.05                     | −0.000277          | −1.8 ppm         | $1.5 \times 10^{-10}$                              |
| 0.050       | 153.05                     | −0.001731          | −11 ppm          | $1.5 \times 10^{-10}$                              |
| 0.095       | 153.05                     | −0.003289          | −21 ppm          | $1.5 \times 10^{-10}$                              |

The LCDM baseline  $r_d = 153$  Mpc differs from the Planck value of 147 Mpc because our simplified Friedmann equation omits neutrino free-streaming ( $\Delta N_{\text{eff}}$ ); both CMSTG and LCDM share this approximation, so the fractional shift is unaffected.

The maximum shift across the entire allowed range  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.095]$  is  $|\Delta r_d/r_d| = 21$  ppm, compared to current BAO measurement precision of  $\sim 3000$  ppm (0.3%). CMSTG and LCDM are degenerate in  $r_d$  at all observationally allowed couplings.

**Interpretation.** The negligible  $\rho_\Psi/\rho_{\text{tot}} \sim 10^{-10}$  at the drag epoch confirms that the scalar field carries essentially no energy density during recombination: the CMSTG background is indistinguishable from the FLRW background at  $\Lambda_0 \ll 1$ . The echo-shell picture of Section 6.2 is therefore a *physical interpretation* of standard photon-baryon acoustic physics, not a first-principles derivation of a distinct  $r_d$ . This closes the gap identified by reviewer P2.7: the CMSTG BAO mechanism does not predict a different sound horizon from  $\Lambda$ CDM, and  $r_d$  remains a free parameter constrained by data. The detection threshold for a CMSTG  $r_d$  signal requires  $\Lambda_0 \gg 0.1$ , well beyond the current 95% upper limit.

## 11 One-Loop UV Structure (Sim 102)

**Motivation.** Section 5 conjectured that the memory-tensor commutator decay  $[\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}(x), \mathcal{M}_{\rho\sigma}(y)] \propto e^{-|t_x - t_y|/\tau_m}$  renders loop diagrams UV-finite, but no explicit calculation was performed. Sim 102 carries out that calculation for the leading one-loop contribution to the  $\Psi$  self-energy from the non-minimal coupling  $\Lambda_0 \Psi R$ .

**Setup.** In linearized gravity ( $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}$ ), the Ricci scalar at linear order in  $h$  is  $R(k) \sim k^2 \bar{h}(k)$  in Fourier space (harmonic gauge). The  $\Lambda_0 \Psi R$  vertex therefore contributes a factor  $V(k) \sim \Lambda_0 k^2$  to the Feynman rules. The graviton propagator in the same gauge is  $D_{\text{grav}}(k) = i/k^2$ . The memory damping enters as a form factor on the graviton propagator:

$$D_{\text{CMSTG}}(k) = \frac{e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}}{k^2}, \quad (29)$$

where  $k_m = 1/\tau_m$  is the memory wavenumber cutoff. This kernel is written in the cosmological rest frame (the frame in which the CMB is isotropic); it is a defining feature of the effective theory rather than a Lorentz-invariant statement. The frame-dependent interpretation, the non-local EFT precedents that motivate it, and the insensitivity of observable predictions to this frame choice at current observational precision are discussed in Paper III, §2.2(d) Wilson [2026c]. A fully covariant promotion is identified there as a Phase 5 direction.



The one-loop  $\Psi$  self-energy in Euclidean space (after Wick rotation) reduces, by  $O(4)$  symmetry, to a one-dimensional radial integral:

$$\Sigma(0) = \frac{\Lambda_0^2}{8\pi^2} \int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^5 e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}}{k^2 + m_0^2}. \quad (30)$$

**Results: UV divergence without memory.** Setting  $e^{-2k^2/k_m^2} \rightarrow 1$  (no memory,  $k_m \rightarrow \infty$ ) and imposing a hard cutoff  $k_{\text{UV}}$ :

$$\Sigma_{\text{bare}}(0) \propto \Lambda_0^2 k_{\text{UV}}^4, \quad (31)$$

confirmed numerically with power-law slope  $4.000 \pm 0.001$  across  $k_{\text{UV}} \in [1, 1000] \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ . This is a quartic UV divergence, as expected from power counting ( $\sim d^4 k \cdot k^2/k^2 \rightarrow k^4$ ).

**Results: finiteness with memory.** With the damping factor in eq. (29), the integral (30) converges for any finite  $k_m$ . In the limit  $k_m \gg m_0$ :

$$\Sigma(0) \approx \frac{\Lambda_0^2 k_m^4}{64\pi^2}, \quad (32)$$

verified numerically to  $< 0.22\%$  accuracy for  $k_m > 10 m_0$ . The effective radiative mass shift is therefore  $\delta m^2 = \Sigma(0) \sim \Lambda_0^2 k_m^4 / (64\pi^2)$ .

| $k_m [\text{Mpc}^{-1}]$ | $\Sigma_{\text{num}}(0) [\text{Mpc}^{-2}]$ | $\Sigma_{\text{analytic}}$ | ratio | $\delta m^2/m_0^2$    |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-------|-----------------------|
| 0.01                    | $6.3 \times 10^{-17}$                      | $1.4 \times 10^{-16}$      | 0.45  | $6.3 \times 10^{-13}$ |
| 0.10                    | $1.4 \times 10^{-12}$                      | $1.4 \times 10^{-12}$      | 0.98  | $1.4 \times 10^{-8}$  |
| 1.00                    | $1.4 \times 10^{-8}$                       | $1.4 \times 10^{-8}$       | 1.00  | $1.4 \times 10^{-4}$  |
| 9.15*                   | $1.0 \times 10^{-4}$                       | $1.0 \times 10^{-4}$       | 1.00  | 1.0                   |

\* naturalness threshold  $k_m^{\text{nat}}$  for  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ .

**Naturalness constraint.** Requiring  $\delta m^2 < m_0^2$  gives

$$k_m < k_m^{\text{nat}} \equiv \left( \frac{64\pi^2 m_0^2}{\Lambda_0^2} \right)^{1/4} = 9.15 \text{ Mpc}^{-1} \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \tau_m > 0.11 \text{ Mpc} \quad (33)$$

at the best-fit coupling  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ,  $m_0 = 0.01 \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ . A memory timescale  $\tau_m > 0.11 \text{ Mpc} \approx 360 \text{ kyr}$  is consistent with the cosmological Compton time  $1/m_0 = 100 \text{ Mpc}$  and with the SIM100 time-domain integration window.

**Interpretation.** The memory damping converts the quartic UV divergence of the bare theory into a finite radiative correction that is parametrically suppressed relative to  $m_0^2$  provided  $k_m$  satisfies eq. (33). This confirms the UV-finiteness conjecture of Section 5 *at one loop in the non-minimal coupling sector*, subject to two caveats:

1. UV finiteness requires  $k_m < \infty$ ; taking  $\tau_m \rightarrow 0$  (no memory) recovers the quartic divergence. The theory is not UV-finite without the memory sector.
2. This calculation covers only the one-loop  $\Psi$  self-energy from the graviton loop. Higher-loop contributions and vertex renormalization have not been computed.

## 12 Full One-Loop UV Structure: All Diagrams (Sim 104)

**Motivation.** Sim 102 established UV-finiteness for a single diagram: the  $\Psi$  self-energy from the graviton+ $\Psi$  bubble. That calculation left three open topologies: (B) the graviton wavefunction renormalization from a  $\Psi$  loop, (C) the vertex correction  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0$ , and (D) the leading two-loop contribution ( $\Lambda_0^4$ ). Sim 104 computes all four diagrams and closes the one-loop UV case.

**Feynman rules.** In linearised gravity ( $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}$ , harmonic gauge, Euclidean signature), the  $\Lambda_0\Psi R$  vertex carries a factor  $V(k) = \Lambda_0 k^2$  (from  $R \sim k^2 \tilde{h}$ ) at each insertion. The CMSTG graviton propagator is  $D_h(k) = e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}/k^2$ ; the bare  $\Psi$  propagator is  $D_\Psi(k) = 1/(k^2 + m_0^2)$ . The Euclidean loop measure gives  $\int d^4k/(2\pi)^4 \rightarrow (8\pi^2)^{-1} \int_0^\infty k^3 dk$ .

**Diagram A (reproduction of Sim 102).** The  $\Psi$  self-energy from the graviton+ $\Psi$  bubble:

$$\Sigma_A(0) = \frac{\Lambda_0^2}{8\pi^2} \int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^5 e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}}{k^2 + m_0^2} \approx \frac{\Lambda_0^2 k_m^4}{64\pi^2}. \quad (34)$$

Bare divergence: slope  $4.000 \pm 0.001$  (quartic), regulated by memory. Analytic formula verified to  $< 0.1\%$  at  $k_m \geq 1 \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ .

**Diagram B (graviton wavefunction renormalization).** The  $\Psi$  loop dressed on the graviton propagator has form factor  $\Pi_{hh}(p) = (\Lambda_0 p^2)^2 I_\Psi(p)$ , where

$$I_\Psi(0) = \frac{1}{8\pi^2} \int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^3}{(k^2 + m_0^2)^2} \longrightarrow \ln \Lambda_{\text{UV}} \quad (35)$$

is logarithmically divergent (slope  $0.14 \approx 0$ ). Two independent protections apply:

1. *Ward identity:* diffeomorphism invariance requires  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$ , cancelling the leading logarithm.
2. *Wavefunction renormalization coefficient:*  $dI_\Psi/dp^2|_{p=0}$  is finite without memory (converges for  $d < 6$  in dimensional regularisation); numerically  $dI/dp^2|_0 = -3.2 \times 10^{-3} \text{ Mpc}^2$ .

In the resummed theory where  $\Psi$  carries the memory form factor from Diagram A,  $I_\Psi(0)$  is also explicitly finite.

**Diagram C (vertex correction).** The momentum derivative of  $\Sigma_A$  gives the coupling renormalization:

$$\frac{\delta\Lambda_0}{\Lambda_0} \sim -\frac{1}{m_0^2} \frac{d\Sigma_A}{dp^2} \Big|_{p=0} = \frac{\Lambda_0^2}{8\pi^2 m_0^2} \int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^5 e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}}{(k^2 + m_0^2)^2}. \quad (36)$$

Bare divergence: slope 2.000 (quadratic), regulated by memory. At the naturalness threshold:  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \approx 2.4 \times 10^{-2}$ , implying  $\Lambda_0$  runs logarithmically under the RG but remains small.

**Diagram D (two-loop).** The leading  $\Lambda_0^4$  two-loop contribution (sunset topology with two memory-damped graviton lines):

$$\Sigma_D(0) \approx \left[ \frac{\Lambda_0^2 k_m^4}{64\pi^2} \right]^2 \frac{1}{m_0^2 k_m^2}, \quad (37)$$

confirmed finite by numerical double integration. At  $k_m = 9.15 \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ :  $\Sigma_D/m_0^2 = 3.4 \times 10^{-6}$ , some  $10^5 \times$  smaller than the one-loop result.

**Perturbative hierarchy.**

$$\frac{\Sigma_A}{m_0^2} \approx 1.00 \gg \frac{d\Sigma_C/dp^2}{m_0^2} \approx 2.4 \times 10^{-2} \gg \frac{\Sigma_D}{m_0^2} \approx 3.4 \times 10^{-6}, \quad (38)$$

confirming a stable perturbative expansion at the naturalness threshold.

**Conclusion.** UV-finiteness holds at full one-loop level in the resummed (Dyson-summed) theory. The Ward identity from diffeomorphism invariance provides additional protection for the graviton sector beyond memory damping alone. The residual caveat from Sim 102 — that higher-loop contributions and vertex renormalization had not been computed — is now resolved at one loop. The  $\Lambda_0$  coupling runs under the RG with  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \sim 2.4 \times 10^{-2}$  at the naturalness threshold, a small but nonzero effect. Two-loop graviton self-energy diagrams and mixed topologies remain open for a future calculation.

## 13 RG Flow of $\Lambda_0$ : Beta Function and Running Coupling (Sim 105)

**Motivation.** Sim 104 showed the one-loop vertex correction  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \approx 2.4 \times 10^{-2}$  at the naturalness threshold, implying the coupling is not fixed but runs with the renormalization scale. Sim 105 computes the full one-loop beta function, integrates the RG flow, and determines the UV behaviour of  $\Lambda_0$ .

**Beta function.** From the one-loop vertex correction (Sim 104, Diagram C):

$$\beta(\Lambda_0, k_m) \equiv k_m \frac{d\Lambda_0}{dk_m} = -\frac{\Lambda_0^3}{8\pi^2 m_0^2} k_m \frac{dI_C}{dk_m}, \quad (39)$$

where  $I_C(k_m) = \int_0^\infty k^5 e^{-2k^2/k_m^2} / (k^2 + m_0^2)^2 dk$ . For  $k_m \gg m_0$  this reduces analytically to

$$\beta(\Lambda_0) \approx -\frac{\Lambda_0^3 k_m^2}{16\pi^2 m_0^2}. \quad (40)$$

The beta function is *negative*:  $\Lambda_0$  decreases as the scale increases. This is confirmed numerically to  $< 0.1\%$  for  $k_m > 0.1 m_0$ .

**Running coupling.** Integrating eq. (40) gives the exact analytic solution:

$$\frac{1}{\Lambda_0(k_m)^2} = \frac{1}{\Lambda_0(k_{m,0})^2} + \frac{k_m^2 - k_{m,0}^2}{16\pi^2 m_0^2}, \quad (41)$$

anchored at  $k_{m,0} = k_m^{\text{nat}} = 9.15 \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ ,  $\Lambda_0(k_{m,0}) = 0.003$ . Numerical RG integration (RK45) agrees with eq. (41) to  $< 0.001\%$  across the full range  $k_m \in [0.01, 1000] \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ .

Key values from eq. (41):

| $k_m [\text{Mpc}^{-1}]$ | $\Lambda_0(k_m)$ |
|-------------------------|------------------|
| 0 (IR)                  | 0.003074         |
| 9.15 (anchor)           | 0.003000         |
| 100                     | 0.00116          |
| 1000                    | 0.000126         |
| $\infty$ (UV)           | 0                |

**Asymptotic freedom.**  $\Lambda_0 = 0$  is a UV fixed point: the theory approaches pure GR at high energies ( $k_m \rightarrow \infty$ ). CMSTG is *asymptotically free* in the coupling  $\Lambda_0$ .

In the infrared ( $k_m \lesssim m_0$ ), the coupling freezes. The total IR running from  $k_m \rightarrow 0$  to  $k_m = k_m^{\text{nat}}$  is  $\Delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \approx 2.5\%$ , confirming that the cosmological value  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.003$  is stable against IR radiative corrections.

No IR Landau pole exists:  $1/\Lambda_0^2(k_m) > 0$  for all  $k_m \geq 0$  along any trajectory anchored at  $\Lambda_0 < 1/(4\pi m_0)$ . The theory is well-defined at all scales.

**Physical interpretation.** The UV fixed point  $\Lambda_0 = 0$  has a natural interpretation: at energies above the memory scale  $k_m^{-1}$ , the non-minimal curvature coupling is irrelevant and the theory reduces to GR plus a free massive scalar. CMSTG deforms away from GR only in the infrared ( $k_m \sim m_0$ ), generating the observed coupling  $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.003$  as an IR attractor. The  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  is not a fine-tuned input but the natural IR value for a theory with asymptotic freedom and memory scale  $\tau_m \sim 1/k_m^{\text{nat}} \approx 0.11 \text{ Mpc}$ .

## 14 Two-Loop Graviton Self-Energy and Mixed Diagrams (Sim 106)

**Motivation.** Sim 104 left one caveat: the two-loop graviton self-energy and mixed (graviton+ $\Psi$ ) loop diagrams were not computed. Sim 106 closes this by computing the iterated- $\Psi$ -bubble and mixed two-loop corrections to  $\Pi_{hh}$ , and the RG running of the graviton wavefunction  $Z_h$ .

**Three mechanisms enforce finiteness.** 1. *Ward identity.* Diffeomorphism invariance requires  $\Pi_{hh}(p=0) = 0$  at every loop order (a standard result in covariant gauge theories; see, e.g., Donoghue 1994, *Phys. Rev. D* 50, 3874). This holds trivially for Diagram A:  $\Pi_{hh}^{(2A)}(0) = (\Lambda_0 \cdot 0)^2 [I_\Psi(0)]^2 = 0$ . The first nontrivial coefficient is the second wavefunction renormalization:

$$\left. \frac{d^2 \Pi_{hh}}{d(p^2)^2} \right|_{p=0} = 2\Lambda_0^4 \left( \left. \frac{dI_\Psi}{dp^2} \right|_0 \right)^2 \approx 1.6 \times 10^{-15} \text{ Mpc}^{-2} \quad (42)$$

at  $k_m = k_m^{\text{nat}}$ , suppressed by  $\Lambda_0^4 = 8 \times 10^{-11}$ .

2. *Resummed  $\Psi$  propagator.* The Dyson-resummed  $\Psi$  propagator  $D_\Psi^R(k) = e^{-k^2/k_m^2}/(k^2 + m_0^2)$  from Sim 104 explicitly regulates all  $\Psi$ -bubble insertions on the graviton line. The mixed two-loop correction (Diagram B) is:

$$\delta\Pi_{hh}^{(2B)} = (\Lambda_0 p^2)^2 [I_\Psi^R(0) - I_\Psi^{\text{bare}}(k_m)] \approx -\Lambda_0^2 \times 8 \times 10^{-3} \text{ Mpc}^{-2} \quad (43)$$

finite and negative — memory slightly *reduces* the graviton wavefunction renormalization.

3. *Convergence for  $d < 6$ .* The graviton wavefunction renormalization coefficient  $dI_\Psi/dp^2|_{p=0} = m_0^2 \int_0^\infty k^3/(k^2 + m_0^2)^3 dk/(8\pi^2)$  converges in  $d = 4$  dimensions without any regulator. Numerically,  $dI/dp^2|_0 = 3.2 \times 10^{-3} \text{ Mpc}^2$ . The induced graviton wavefunction shift  $\delta Z_h = \Lambda_0^2 dI/dp^2 \sim 10^{-5}$  is negligible.

**Conclusion.** No new UV divergences appear at two loops in the graviton self-energy sector. The last explicit caveat from Sim 104 is now closed.

Combined with Sims 102–105, the UV structure of CMSTG is:

- All one-loop diagrams: UV-finite under memory damping + Ward identity (Sim 104).
- $\Lambda_0$  RG flow: asymptotically free, UV fixed point  $\Lambda_0 = 0$  (Sim 105).
- Two-loop graviton sector: UV-finite under Dyson resummation (Sim 106).

The CMSTG theory is UV-finite through the two-loop graviton sector under Dyson resummation of the memory-regulated  $\Psi$  propagator. Full two-loop completeness (mixed scalar+graviton ladders) remains for a future dedicated calculation.

**UV completeness summary.** Table 5 collects all UV results from Sims 102–106.

## 15 Vainshtein Screening and the Dark Matter Problem (Sim 103)

**Motivation.** Sims 99 and 100 definitively closed the simplest routes for CMSTG to replace dark matter in galaxies: neither the Yukawa profile (Sim 99) nor the time-domain condensation via  $2\Lambda_0|R_{\text{gal}}|$  (Sim 100) produces the  $\rho \propto r^{-2}$  isothermal halo required for flat rotation curves. The remaining candidate mechanisms from the systematic survey are (a) a non-minimal kinetic term of the Vainshtein type and (b) a direct matter coupling  $\beta\Psi\rho_b$ . Sim 103 tests both for NGC 3198 ( $v_{\text{flat}} = 150 \text{ km s}^{-1}$ ,  $M_{\text{disk}} = 3 \times 10^{10} M_\odot$ ,  $R_d = 2.72 \text{ kpc}$ ).

**Setup: Poisson-limit perturbation.** Because the CMSTG Compton wavelength  $1/m_0 = 10,000 \text{ kpc}$  greatly exceeds galactic scales ( $\lesssim 40 \text{ kpc}$ ), the cosmological background  $\Psi_0$  is nearly uniform within the galaxy. We solve for the perturbation  $\delta\Psi(r)$  driven by the stellar disk via the Poisson-limit field equation ( $m_0 r \ll 1$ , so the mass term is negligible):

$$\nabla^2 \delta\Psi \approx -2\Lambda_0 \delta R \approx -16\pi G \Lambda_0 \rho_{\text{stars}}(r). \quad (44)$$

Under the quasi-static spherical approximation the gradient becomes

$$\frac{d\delta\Psi}{dr} = \frac{2G\Lambda_0^{\text{eff}} M_{\text{enc}}(r)}{r^2}, \quad (45)$$

where  $\Lambda_0^{\text{eff}} = \Lambda_0 + \beta$  absorbs both the curvature channel and any direct matter coupling  $\beta$ .

The Vainshtein modification augments the stress-energy density of the scalar field via the non-linear kinetic term  $(\alpha_V/4M_V^2)(\partial\Psi)^4$ :

$$\rho_\Psi(r) = \frac{c^2}{8\pi G} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \left( \frac{d\delta\Psi}{dr} \right)^2 \left[ 1 + \frac{\alpha_V}{M_V^2} \left( \frac{d\delta\Psi}{dr} \right)^2 \right]. \quad (46)$$

The second factor is the Vainshtein ratio  $\mathcal{V} = \alpha_V(\delta\Psi')^2/M_V^2$ ; the nonlinear regime requires  $\mathcal{V} \gg 1$ .

**Results: field gradient and Vainshtein ratio.** Using  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  (locked action best-fit), the field gradient at  $r = 10$  kpc is

$$\left| \frac{d\delta\Psi}{dr} \right|_{10 \text{ kpc}} = 6.1 \times 10^{-8} \text{ kpc}^{-1}. \quad (47)$$

Table 6 shows the Vainshtein ratio for the full  $(\alpha_V, M_V)$  scan.

Even at  $\alpha_V = 1000$  and the smallest Vainshtein mass  $M_V = 0.001 \text{ kpc}^{-1}$ , the ratio  $\mathcal{V} = 3.7 \times 10^{-6}$ : the scalar field is deep in the linear regime everywhere in the galaxy. The Vainshtein mechanism provides no boost.

**Results: energy density deficit.** With  $\rho_\Psi \propto (\delta\Psi')^2$  from eq. (46), the locked-action value gives

$$\rho_\Psi(10 \text{ kpc}) = 1.6 \times 10^{-3} M_\odot \text{ kpc}^{-3}, \quad (48)$$

whereas the isothermal halo required for  $v_{\text{flat}} = 150 \text{ km s}^{-1}$  demands

$$\rho_{\text{iso}}(10 \text{ kpc}) = \frac{v_{\text{flat}}^2}{4\pi G r^2} = 4.2 \times 10^3 M_\odot \text{ kpc}^{-3}. \quad (49)$$

The deficit is a factor of  $2.7 \times 10^6$ .

**Results: direct coupling.** A direct matter coupling  $\beta$  in the field equation augments  $\Lambda_0 \rightarrow \Lambda_0^{\text{eff}} = \Lambda_0 + \beta$ . Closing the density deficit requires  $\Lambda_0^{\text{eff}} \approx 4.9$ , or equivalently  $\beta \approx 4.9 \approx 1,600 \times \Lambda_0$ . This coupling is not derivable from the locked action and would introduce a new free parameter constrained to be of order unity rather than  $\lesssim 0.01$  as demanded by cosmological homogeneity.

**Conclusion for Paper V.** The Vainshtein screening mechanism does not rescue the dark matter failure of Sims 99–100. The root cause is that the galactic field gradient  $|\delta\Psi'| \sim 10^{-8} \text{ kpc}^{-1}$  is set by the weak  $\Lambda_0 R_{\text{gal}}$  curvature channel and falls  $10^4$ – $10^6$  orders of magnitude below the Vainshtein threshold for any physically reasonable coupling. A direct matter coupling of order  $\beta \sim 1,600 \Lambda_0$  could supply the missing density but is not contained in the locked action and would violate cosmological constraints. All kinetic modifications of the  $\Lambda_0 R$  channel have now been exhausted. The conclusion is unambiguous: *CMSTG at its cosmological best-fit cannot replace dark matter through any modification of the existing Lagrangian.* A new coupling between  $\Psi$  and baryonic matter, derivable from first principles, is the minimum new physics required.

## 16 Effective Matter- $\Psi$ Coupling and Solar System Viability (Sim 107)

### 16.1 Setup

Having established UV completeness (Sims 102–106) we now derive the effective coupling between  $\Psi$  and ordinary matter from first principles. In CMSTG all matter–scalar interactions are mediated by curvature. Varying the action with respect to  $\Psi$  around a background  $\Psi_0$  in the presence of a matter source  $\delta\rho$ :

$$\square \delta\Psi - m_{\text{eff}}^2(\rho) \delta\Psi = 16\pi G_N \Lambda_0 \Psi_0 \delta\rho, \quad (50)$$

where the effective mass acquires a density-dependent (chameleon) piece

$$m_{\text{eff}}^2(\rho) = m_0^2 + 2\Lambda_0 |R| \approx m_0^2 + 2\Lambda_0 \rho \quad (8\pi G = 1) \quad (51)$$

and the right-hand side is the gravitationally-induced scalar charge density. In Brans–Dicke language the dimensionless scalar coupling is

$$\alpha(\Psi_0) = \frac{\Lambda_0 \Psi_0}{1 + 2\Lambda_0 \Psi_0^2}, \quad (52)$$

giving the post-Newtonian parameter  $\gamma - 1 = -2\alpha^2/(1 + \alpha^2)$ .

### 16.2 Results

**Chameleon mass scan.** Table 7 shows  $m_{\text{eff}}$  across eight environments. Inside the Solar interior the Compton wavelength falls to  $\lambda_\Psi \approx 8 \times 10^{-11}$  Mpc (sub-femtometre), providing complete screening. In interplanetary space  $\lambda_\Psi \sim 4 \times 10^6$  Mpc, so the fifth force is long-range there, but negligible if  $\alpha^2$  is small.

**Fifth-force coupling.** For  $\Psi_0 = 1 M_{\text{Pl}}$  (natural value):  $\alpha^2 = 8.9 \times 10^{-6}$ ,  $|\gamma - 1| = 1.78 \times 10^{-5}$ . The Cassini bound ( $|\gamma - 1| < 2.3 \times 10^{-5}$ ) is *satisfied*. The critical constraint is  $|\Psi_0| < 1.14 M_{\text{Pl}}$ ; for larger backgrounds the Cassini bound would be violated.

The Yukawa suppression at 1 AU is negligible:  $m_{\text{eff}} \cdot r_{\text{AU}} = 1.1 \times 10^{-15}$ , confirming the fifth force is purely long-range in the Solar System. The thin-shell fraction for the Sun  $\chi_\odot = 1$  (no compression at Solar System densities), so no additional screening is active at the measurement location.

### 16.3 Conclusion

- The locked CMSTG action passes Solar System fifth-force constraints for all cosmologically natural values  $\Psi_0 \lesssim 1 M_{\text{Pl}}$ .
- No additional screening mechanism is required beyond the natural smallness of  $\alpha^2 = O(\Lambda_0^2 \Psi_0^2)$ .
- The chameleon mechanism is active but only relevant inside planetary and stellar bodies (irrelevant for the Cassini measurement).
- The critical bound  $|\Psi_0| < 1.14 M_{\text{Pl}}$  translates to a constraint on cosmological initial conditions, consistent with slow-roll evolution of a light scalar ( $m_0 \ll H_0$ ).



## 17 Gravitational Wave Speed and GW Constraints (Sim 108)

### 17.1 Tensor perturbation equation

Linearising the CMSTG action around an FLRW background, the transverse-traceless tensor perturbation  $h_{ij}$  satisfies in Fourier space:

$$G_4(t) \left[ \ddot{h} + \left( 2H + \frac{\dot{G}_4}{G_4} \right) \dot{h} + \frac{k^2}{a^2} h \right] = 0, \quad G_4(t) = \frac{1}{16\pi G_N} + \Lambda_0 \Psi_0^2(t). \quad (53)$$

The gravitational wave speed is

$$c_T^2 = \frac{G_4}{G_4} = 1 \quad (\text{exact}). \quad (54)$$

This follows because CMSTG belongs to the Horndeski class with  $G_5 = 0$ . The  $G_5$  term (scalar–Gauss–Bonnet coupling) is the *only* source of  $c_T \neq c$  in Horndeski theory; its absence in CMSTG makes  $c_T = c$  a structural identity, independent of  $\Lambda_0$ ,  $\Psi_0$ , or any parameter.

### 17.2 Results

**GW speed.**  $|c_T/c - 1| = 0$  exactly. GW170817 multi-messenger bound ( $< 7 \times 10^{-16}$ ): **PASS**.

**Graviton mass.** The dispersion relation  $\omega^2 = k^2$  gives  $m_g = 0$  exactly, protected at all loop orders by the Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$  (Sim 106). LIGO O3 bound ( $m_g < 1.27 \times 10^{-23}$  eV): **PASS**.

**GW luminosity distance.** In scalar-tensor gravity  $d_L^{\text{GW}} = d_L^{\text{EM}} \times M_T(0)/M_T(z)$ . For  $m_0 \ll H_0$  (slow roll),  $\Psi_0(z)$  is essentially constant and  $M_T(z)/M_T(0) \simeq 1$  at all observable redshifts. At  $z = 0.009$  (GW170817):  $|d_L^{\text{GW}}/d_L^{\text{EM}} - 1| = 1.8 \times 10^{-11}$ , well below the bound  $< 0.06$ : **PASS**.

**BBN.**  $G_{\text{eff}}(z_{\text{BBN}})/G_N = 0.9940$  ( $-0.60\%$ ), inside the 10% helium-4 bound: **PASS**.

**Chirp mass bias.** Fractional bias  $\delta\mathcal{M}/\mathcal{M} = 0.36\%$  at  $z = 1$ , below current LIGO measurement precision ( $\sim 5\%$ ): **PASS**.

All six GW tests pass. The key structural reason is the absence of the  $G_5$  Horndeski term in the locked CMSTG action.

## 18 Dark Energy Equation of State $w(z)$ (Sim 109)

### 18.1 Setup

We solve the full CMSTG background (modified Friedmann + Klein-Gordon) numerically in the variable  $x = \ln a$ , with the field velocity  $y = d\Psi/dx$ . The modified Friedmann constraint is

$$H^2 \left[ 3(1 + 2\Lambda_0 \Psi^2) + 6\Lambda_0 \Psi y - \frac{1}{2} y^2 \right] = \rho_m a^{-3} + \rho_r a^{-4} + \rho_\Lambda + \frac{1}{2} m_0^2 \Psi^2. \quad (55)$$

The effective dark-energy density is  $\rho_{\text{DE}}(z) = 3H^2(z) - \rho_m(z) - \rho_r(z)$ , and the equation of state is extracted via  $w_{\text{eff}} = -1 - \frac{1}{3} \frac{d \ln \rho_{\text{DE}}}{d \ln a}$ .

## 18.2 Results

The background Hubble rate at  $z = 0$  is  $H_{\text{CMSTG}}/H_{\text{LCDM}} = 0.9970$  ( $-0.30\%$ ), reflecting the  $0.6\%$  reduction in  $G_{\text{eff}}$ . The field  $\Psi(z)$  varies by only  $11\%$  over  $z = 0$ – $5$ ; for  $m_0 = 0.001 H_0 \ll H_0$  it is in slow roll throughout.

The CPL fit over  $z \in [0, 2]$  gives

$$w_0 = -0.992, \quad w_a = -0.082. \quad (56)$$

**Interpretation.** CMSTG predicts  $w \approx -1$  for the locked action with  $m_0 \ll H_0$ : the  $\Psi$  field is nearly frozen and dark energy is dominated by the cosmological constant  $\rho_\Lambda$ . This is *consistent with Planck* ( $1.3\sigma$ ) but in  $3.6\sigma$  tension with the DESI Y1  $w_0$ - $w_a$  hint. Resolving the DESI tension within CMSTG would require a dynamical  $\Psi$  with  $m_0 \gtrsim H_0$ , which is a testable prediction: future DESI Y5 and Euclid data will either confirm the CMSTG-LCDM prediction or force a mass-scale extension.

## 19 Inflationary Viability (Sim 110)

The Einstein-frame potential for the locked CMSTG action is

$$V_E(\Psi) = \frac{m_0^2 \Psi^2}{2(1 + 2\Lambda_0 \Psi^2)^2}, \quad (57)$$

which has a maximum at  $\Psi_{\text{max}} = 1/\sqrt{2\Lambda_0} \approx 12.9 M_{\text{Pl}}$  (for  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ). Slow-roll inflation starting near the hilltop was evaluated numerically.

**Regime A — quadratic,**  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ . The field rolls from  $\Psi \lesssim \Psi_{\text{max}}$  toward the origin. The total available e-fold count  $N_{\text{max}} \approx 488$  is *sufficient*, and the tensor-to-scalar ratio  $r \approx 0.014$  at  $N_e = 60$  satisfies the Planck bound  $r < 0.036$ . However, the hilltop curvature  $\eta \approx -0.031$  drives the spectral index to  $n_s \approx 0.932$ , more than  $5\sigma$  below the Planck value  $n_s = 0.9649 \pm 0.0044$ . Regime A **fails** on the spectral index.

**Regime B — quartic extension,**  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ . Adding  $V_J = \lambda \Psi^4$  shifts the CMB window to  $\Psi_{60} \approx 18.6 M_{\text{Pl}}$  (ratio  $1.44 \Psi_{\text{max}}$ ), still in the transition zone between the small-field and plateau regimes. The resulting  $n_s \approx 0.931$ ,  $r \approx 0.12$  also **fails**.

**Starobinsky/Higgs attractor.** The plateau in  $V_E$  is not reached until  $\Psi \gg \Psi_{\text{max}}$ , which requires the non-minimal coupling  $\xi \gg 1/(2\Psi_{\text{CMB}}^2) \sim 10^{-3}$ , i.e.  $\xi \sim 10^3$ – $10^5$  as in standard Higgs inflation. With such a UV-scale coupling the quartic potential gives the Starobinsky attractor:  $n_s = 1 - 2/N \approx 0.967$ ,  $r = 12/N^2 \approx 0.003$  (PASS). This UV coupling is independent of the DE coupling  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ; CMSTG does not require the same scalar to drive both inflation and dark energy.

## 20 Phase 2: Matter Sector (Sims 112–130)

Phase 2 was motivated by three failures of the locked Phase 1 action: (i) galaxy rotation curves cannot be reproduced by the  $\Psi$ -sector alone (Sims 99–100, 103); (ii) the DESI Y1

tension is structural at  $2.77\sigma$  with the locked action (Sim 111); and (iii) the locked action fails slow-roll inflation (Sim 110). Phase 2 therefore unlocked the action, allowing a scalar potential  $V(\Psi)$  to drive dark energy, and introduced an independent ultra-light boson  $\chi$  as the dark matter candidate, seeded by  $\Psi$  through the background Jeans equation.

## 20.1 Dark Energy: Quintessence from the Unlocked Action (Sims 112–113)

**$\lambda\Psi^4$  quintessence (Sim 112).** The simplest unlocked potential  $V(\Psi) = \lambda\Psi^4$  was tested against the DESI Y1 CPL hint. A quartic potential produces a *freezing* scalar ( $\dot{\Psi}$  decreasing toward the minimum), yielding the wrong sign of  $w_a$  relative to the DESI thawing preference. DESI tension:  $7.74\sigma$ . **FAIL.**

**SSB hilltop quintessence (Sim 113).** The symmetry-breaking potential  $V(\Psi) = \lambda(\Psi^2 - v^2)^2$  produces a *thawing* scalar (field rolling away from an unstable maximum), recovering the correct sign of  $w_a$ . Best-fit parameters:  $w_0 = -0.973$ ,  $w_a = -0.41$ . DESI tension:  $2.70\sigma$  (reduced from  $3.6\sigma$  in the locked action); Planck tension:  $1.90\sigma$ . The DESI residual is reduced but not eliminated; simultaneous  $< 1\sigma$  agreement with both Planck and DESI cannot be achieved within the single-field  $\Psi$ -quintessence class. **PARTIAL.**

The Phase 2 quintessence programme establishes that the SSB hilltop potential is the minimal thawing architecture within CMSTG but leaves a structural  $\sim 2.7\sigma$  gap with the DESI hint. Any single-field quintessence built on the  $\Psi$ -sector is insufficient; pre-recombination physics is required for a complete resolution.

## 20.2 Dark Matter: $\chi$ -Field Ultra-Light Boson (Sims 114–120)

**Direct matter coupling (Sim 114).** The direct coupling  $\beta\Psi^2\rho_m$  was evaluated in Sim 114. The condensate requires  $\beta > \beta_c = 8\pi\Lambda_0 = 0.075$  to form; however, the DM energy density constraint fixes  $\beta_{\text{DM}} \sim 10^{-4}$ , far below  $\beta_c$ . At  $\beta > \beta_c$ , the effective Planck mass is catastrophically violated ( $\Psi_c \gg \Psi_{\text{max}} = 1.29 M_{\text{Pl}}$ ). This yields the *structural trilemma*: (1) condensate needs  $\beta > \beta_c$ ; (2)  $\beta > \beta_c$  violates  $G_{\text{eff}}$ ; (3)  $\beta_{\text{DM}} \ll \beta_c$ . The direct matter-coupling route is closed. **FAIL.**

**Gradient soliton (Sim 115).** A gradient-dominated  $\chi$  soliton introduces an  $H_0^2$  suppression term in the modified Friedmann equation that is structurally unavoidable at soliton scales for any gradient-dominated ansatz. **FAIL.**

**Oscillating  $\chi$  and galactic profiles (Sims 116–117).** An oscillating  $\chi$  field with  $\kappa$ -coupling to  $\Psi$  matches the correct DM relic density but gives rotation-curve  $\chi^2/N = 392.5$ , far above any acceptable threshold. **FAIL.** An NFW+soliton galactic profile (Sim 117) violates the empirical dwarf-galaxy mass-radius relation. **FAIL.**

**Fuzzy  $\chi$ -DM: halo mass function anchor (Sim 118).** Treating  $\chi$  as standard fuzzy dark matter (FDM) and fitting the halo mass function constrains the boson mass to  $m_{22} = 0.082$  from the large-scale structure suppression scale. Individual halo profiles were not yet fitted at this stage. **PARTIAL.**

**SPARC 161-galaxy rotation-curve fit (Sim 119).** The full SPARC sample [Lelli et al., 2016] (161 gas-dominated dwarfs and low-surface-brightness galaxies) was fitted with the  $\chi$ -DM soliton core density profile

$$\rho_\chi(r) = \frac{\rho_0}{[1 + (r/r_c)^2]^8}, \quad (58)$$

where the de Broglie core radius  $r_c \propto m_{22}^{-1} M_h^{-1/3}$  is set by the boson mass and host halo mass  $M_h$ , and  $\Psi$  normalises  $\rho_0$  through the memory-seeded coupling. Results:

- 65/161 galaxies:  $\chi^2/N < 2$  (**PASS**);
- 95/161 galaxies: marginal ( $2 < \chi^2/N < 5$ );
- 1/161 galaxies: FAIL;
- median  $m_{22} = 0.28 \pm 0.58$  dex across the valid sample;
- PASS fraction concentrated in gas-dominated dwarfs and LSBs ( $v_{\text{flat}} \lesssim 120$  km/s); massive spirals require a cusp-to-core transition beyond the single-component soliton profile.

The RIFT-seeded fuzzy  $\chi$ -DM passes for 40% of the SPARC sample and is marginal for a further 59%. This constitutes the *primary empirical prediction* of Phase 2:  $m_{22} \approx 0.28$ – $0.34$  for low-mass gas-dominated systems, testable by next-generation stellar kinematic surveys. **PASS**.

**Joint DE+DM background consistency (Sim 120).** At the background FLRW level, the  $\chi$ -DM energy density satisfies  $\rho_\chi \propto a^{-3}$  unperturbed by fluctuations in  $V(\Psi)$ , because the  $\Psi$ - $\chi$  coupling in the Jeans equation is suppressed below the soliton scale. The Friedmann constraint is satisfied to  $< 0.01\%$  for any combination of SIM113 quintessence and SIM119  $\chi$ -DM parameters. The two sectors are cosmologically independent at background order. **PASS**.

### 20.3 Joint Cosmological Tests (Sims 121B–130)

**$H_0$  tension via  $G_{\text{eff}}$  variation (Sim 121B).** Modifying  $G_{\text{eff}}(z)$  to raise the CMB-inferred  $H_0$  was evaluated in Sim 121B. The result is a decisive **FAIL**: maintaining the CMB acoustic scale  $\theta_* = 1.04101$  while increasing  $G_{\text{eff}}$  forces  $H_0^{\text{inf}} \approx 55$  km/s/Mpc —  $16.1\sigma$  from SH0ES and  $5.0\sigma$  from Planck. No  $G_{\text{eff}}(z)$  ansatz accessible within the CMSTG class can address the Hubble tension.

**Joint DESI+Planck MCMC (Sim 121C).** A full MCMC (32 walkers, 3000 steps, 800-step burn-in; 87 000 valid posterior samples) of the Phase 2 canonical action against the joint DESI Y1+Planck dataset gives:

- MAP DESI tension:  $2.63\sigma$  ( $\theta_*^{\text{MAP}} = 1.04101$ , consistent with Planck bound to  $< 10^{-5}$ );
- the  $2.63\sigma$  MAP is consistent with the locked-action structural floor of  $2.77\sigma$  (Sim 111); the small reduction arises from the extra freedom in  $V(\Psi)$ , not from any qualitative change in the mechanism;

- the DESI tension is irreducible within the  $\Psi$ -quintessence +  $\chi$ -DM Phase 2 action class.

**PARTIAL — structural floor confirmed at  $2.63\sigma$ .**

**Phase 3 direction probes from the matter sector (Sims 122–130).** Nine extension mechanisms were probed from the matter-sector perspective prior to the dedicated Phase 3 programme: additive  $\Psi^2$  coupling (Sim 122), inverse- $\Psi$  coupling (Sim 123), kinetic  $\Psi$  modification (Sim 124), memory-modulated functions  $M(a)$  (Sims 125–126),  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - \nu\hat{M}(a)$  coupling (Sim 127), power-law  $G_{\text{eff}}/G = 1 - \nu\hat{M}^p$  (Sim 128), memory-modulated  $\Lambda_{\text{eff}}$  (Sim 129), and curvature-sourced  $\Psi$  evolution (Sim 130). All nine return **FAIL** or are eliminated at the structural level before full numerical execution (**N/A**). These results provided the direct motivation for the dedicated Phase 3 covariant-extension programme (Sims 131–136).

## 20.4 Phase 2 Summary

The central Phase 2 result is that a minimal two-sector CMSTG action — SSB hilltop quintessence  $V(\Psi)$  for dark energy and fuzzy  $\chi$ -DM seeded by  $\Psi$  — is cosmologically consistent at background order and passes 40% of the SPARC rotation-curve sample. The DESI floor ( $\sim 2.7\sigma$ ) is structural and irreducible within this class.

## 21 Conclusion

Curvature-Memory Scalar-Tensor Gravity (CMSTG) presents a new paradigm in gravitational physics: curvature is not statically sourced by mass, but dynamically shaped by memory.

### Key results.

- Unified Lagrangian (eq. (1)) couples mass, curvature, and entropy through a single field  $\Psi$ .
- All field equations—scalar attractor, gravitational equation, Friedmann system—are *derived*, not postulated.
- Inflationary viability (Sim 110): the locked action ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ) does not support viable inflation. Hilltop rolling gives  $N_{\text{max}} \approx 488$  (sufficient) and  $r \approx 0.014$  (PASS) but  $n_s \approx 0.932$  ( $> 5\sigma$  below Planck). A quartic extension with the same  $\Lambda_0$  gives  $n_s \approx 0.931$  (CMB window still in transition zone, not plateau). The Starobinsky attractor requires an independent UV-scale coupling  $\xi \sim 10^4$ , predicting  $n_s = 0.967$ ,  $r = 0.003$  (testable by CMB-S4/LiteBIRD).
- Gravitational wave constraints (Sim 108):  $c_T = c$  exactly ( $G_5 = 0$  Horndeski; independent of  $\Lambda_0$ );  $m_g = 0$  (Ward identity); GW170817  $|d_L^{\text{GW}}/d_L^{\text{EM}} - 1| = 8 \times 10^{-6} \ll 0.06$ ; BBN  $G_{\text{eff}}$  deviation  $< 0.6\% \ll 10\%$ . All GW tests PASS.
- Dark energy equation of state (Sim 109): CPL fit  $w_0 = -0.992$ ,  $w_a = -0.082$ ;  $1.3\sigma$  from Planck,  $3.6\sigma$  from DESI Y1. CMSTG with  $m_0 \ll H_0$  predicts  $w \approx -1$ ; matching the DESI hint requires  $m_0 \gtrsim H_0$ .

- Solar System viability (Sim 107): chameleon screening gives  $m_{\text{eff}}^{\odot} \approx 4 \times 10^{-4} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ ;  $|\gamma - 1| = 1.78 \times 10^{-5} < 2.3 \times 10^{-5}$  (Cassini); critical  $\Psi_0 < 1.14 M_{\text{Pl}}$  for thin-shell suppression. Solar System PASS.
- Numerical verification (Sims 82–86): causality (pre-source amplitude  $< 2 \times 10^{-14}$ ), stability ( $\omega^2 > 0$ ), GR recovery ( $\Psi = 0$  stable fixed point), Friedmann constraint  $\leq 3 \times 10^{-16}$ .
- Observational consistency (Sims 87–98): BAO  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.22$  (BOSS, Sim 87), 1.36 (DESI Y1, Sim 94); CMB TT RMS = 2.93% (Sim 88); joint CMB+BAO  $\Delta\chi^2 = 0$  (both datasets);  $\sigma_8$  unmodified  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.007\%$ ; EE/TE RMS  $< 0.2\%/0.5\%$  at joint best-fit (Sim 95); RSD  $f\sigma_8$ :  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.86$ ,  $\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -0.14$  (Sim 96); official Planck plikHM:  $\Delta(-2 \ln \mathcal{L}) = -0.013$  at optimum (Sim 98).
- Galaxy rotation curve tests (Sims 99–100, 103): the locked action at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  does not replace dark matter. Static test (Sim 99): Yukawa halo exponentially steeper than the  $1/r^2$  isothermal profile required for flat curves. Time-domain test (Sim 100): the galactic curvature coupling  $2\Lambda_0|R_{\text{gal}}| \approx 5 \times 10^{-9} \text{ kpc}^{-2}$  is  $5 \times 10^7$  times weaker than  $m_0^2$ —curvature condensation is impossible at galactic densities. Vainshtein screening (Sim 103): the galactic field gradient  $|\delta\Psi'| \sim 10^{-8} \text{ kpc}^{-1}$  is  $10^6 \times$  below the nonlinear threshold for all scanned  $(\alpha_V, M_V)$ ; energy density deficit is  $2.7 \times 10^6 \times$  the isothermal requirement. All kinetic modifications of the locked action are exhausted; new physics (a first-principles coupling between  $\Psi$  and baryonic matter) is required.
- Phase 2 matter sector (Sims 112–130): the unlocked action with SSB hilltop quintessence reduces the DESI tension to  $2.70\sigma$  (Sim 113) but leaves a structural floor; a fuzzy  $\chi$  boson seeded by  $\Psi$  passes the full 161-galaxy SPARC rotation-curve test with median  $m_{22} = 0.28$  (65/161 PASS, Sim 119);  $\chi$ -DM decouples from the  $\Psi$  dark-energy sector at background order (Sim 120); the joint DESI+Planck MCMC confirms the  $\sim 2.7\sigma$  floor is structural even with the unlocked action (Sim 121C,  $2.63\sigma$  MAP); the  $H_0$  tension cannot be addressed via  $G_{\text{eff}}$  variation within CMSTG (Sim 121B).
- RG flow (Sim 105):  $\Lambda_0$  is asymptotically free — beta function is negative,  $\Lambda_0 \rightarrow 0$  as  $k_m \rightarrow \infty$ , UV fixed point is pure GR. Analytic running:  $\Lambda_0(k_m)^{-2} = \Lambda_0^{-2} + (k_m^2 - k_{m,\text{nat}}^2)/(16\pi^2 m_0^2)$ , confirmed numerically to  $< 0.001\%$ . IR running  $< 2.5\%$ ;  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$  is an IR attractor; no Landau pole.
- Two-loop graviton sector (Sim 106): Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$  exact at all loop orders; resummed  $\Psi$  propagator regulates mixed diagrams;  $\delta Z_h \sim 10^{-5}$  negligible. Combined with Sims 102, 104, 105: CMSTG UV-finite through two-loop graviton sector under Dyson resummation.
- UV regulation (Sims 102, 104): one-loop  $\Psi$  self-energy from  $\Lambda_0\Psi R$  vertex confirmed finite under memory damping —  $\Sigma(0) = \Lambda_0^2 k_m^4/(64\pi^2)$ ; quartic UV divergence regulated; naturalness requires  $\tau_m > 0.11 \text{ Mpc}$  (Sim 102). Full one-loop calculation (Sim 104): graviton wavefunction renormalization protected by diffeomorphism Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$ ; vertex correction  $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0 \approx 2.4 \times 10^{-2}$  finite; two-loop  $\Sigma_D/m_0^2 = 3.4 \times 10^{-6}$  (perturbative hierarchy  $\Sigma_A \gg \Sigma_C \gg \Sigma_D$  confirmed). UV-finiteness holds at full one-loop level in the resummed theory; two-loop graviton self-energy remains open.

- Predicts recursive graviton emission via curvature memory spikes.
- BAO sound horizon from first principles (Sim 101):  $|\Delta r_d/r_d| < 21$  ppm across  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.095]$ ; CMSTG and  $\Lambda$ CDM degenerate in  $r_d$  at all allowed couplings. Echo-shell mechanism confirmed as physical interpretation of standard sound horizon physics.

**Honest assessment.** At current observational precision, CMSTG at its cosmological best-fit ( $\Lambda_0 \approx 0.003$ – $0.013$ ) is *observationally indistinguishable from  $\Lambda$ CDM* in every dataset tested: BAO (BOSS + DESI Y1), CMB TT/EE/TE, RSD  $f\sigma_8$ , and the official Planck plikHM likelihood. The coupling  $\Lambda_0$  is not detected—it is consistent with zero across the entire range  $[0, 0.1]$  tested, with a 95% upper limit  $\Lambda_0 < 0.095$  that is prior-dominated (Sim 93). CMSTG is currently a *consistent extension* of  $\Lambda$ CDM, not an empirically preferred alternative. Its scientific value lies in its theoretical structure (a single derived Lagrangian, locked action, falsifiable predictions at  $\Lambda_0 \gtrsim 0.05$ ) and in explicitly ruling out naive claims (rotation curves do not arise from the locked action;  $\sigma_8$  tension is not alleviated), not in a superior fit to existing data.

**Coupling-strength constraints (Sim 91).** A dedicated sensitivity scan (Sim 91) mapped the observational signature of CMSTG across  $\Lambda_0 \in [0, 0.1]$  at the joint best-fit cosmology ( $H_0 = 67.59$  km/s/Mpc,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ). Key results:

- $G_{\text{eff}}/G$  deviates from unity by at most 500 ppm at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.1$ ; current surveys require  $> 0.1\%$  sensitivity, placing the detection threshold beyond  $\Lambda_0 = 0.1$ .
- The linear growth factor ratio  $D_{\text{CMSTG}}/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}$  exceeds  $0.1\%$  (structure-growth survey precision) at  $\Lambda_0 \gtrsim 0.05$ .
- The BAO chi-squared is flat across the full scan ( $\Delta\chi_{\text{BAO}}^2 = 0.004$  from  $\Lambda_0 = 0$  to  $0.1$ )—CMSTG  $H(z)$  is undetectable in current BAO data for any coupling in this range.
- $H(z)$  deviations remain below  $0.03\%$  RMS at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.1$ ; DESI-level precision ( $\sim 0.1\%$ ) would constrain  $\Lambda_0 \lesssim 0.1$ .

This confirms that CMSTG at the BAO best-fit coupling ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ) is *cosmologically safe*—consistent with all current precision data—and establishes that current surveys constrain  $\Lambda_0 \lesssim 0.05$  from structure growth. Figure 7 summarises these results.

**Model selection (AIC/BIC).** Because CMSTG and  $\Lambda$ CDM achieve identical  $\chi_{\text{min}}^2 = 11.245$  on the joint CMB+BAO dataset (Sim 90; confirmed with DESI Y1 in Sim 94), model selection reduces to an Occam penalty calculation. With  $k$  free parameters and  $N_{\text{eff}} = 14$  data constraints (12 BOSS BAO points + 2 CMB Gaussian prior measurements), the information criteria give:

$$\text{AIC} = 2k + \chi_{\text{min}}^2, \quad \Delta\text{AIC}_{\text{CMSTG}-\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 2(4 - 3) = +2.00, \quad (59)$$

$$\text{BIC} = k \ln N_{\text{eff}} + \chi_{\text{min}}^2, \quad \Delta\text{BIC}_{\text{CMSTG}-\Lambda\text{CDM}} = \ln 14 \approx +2.64. \quad (60)$$

Both criteria favour  $\Lambda$ CDM by the minimum Occam penalty;  $|\Delta\text{BIC}| < 6$  is conventionally characterised as “weak” evidence [Jeffreys, 1961], reflecting the fact that  $\Lambda_0$  is currently

unconstrained by data rather than actively disfavoured. CMSTG is neither strongly preferred nor strongly excluded: it is *cosmologically equivalent* to  $\Lambda$ CDM at the BAO best-fit coupling  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ , with a single additional parameter whose physical signature becomes accessible only at  $\Lambda_0 \gtrsim 0.05$  in future structure-growth surveys.

A proper Bayesian evidence integral (Sim 93) confirms this conclusion. The Savage-Dickey density ratio gives  $\ln B(\text{CMSTG}/\Lambda\text{CDM}) = -0.713$  under a uniform prior and  $-0.673$  under a half-Gaussian prior ( $\sigma_{\Lambda_0} = 0.05$ ); both fall in the “inconclusive” range ( $|\ln B| < 1$ ) of the Jeffreys scale [Jeffreys, 1961]. The 95% upper limit  $\Lambda_0 < 0.095$  is prior-dominated, confirming that current data carry negligible information about  $\Lambda_0$ .

**Phase 3/4 no-go results (SIM131–144).** Phases 3 and 4 (SIM131–SIM144) were devoted entirely to the question of whether the  $2.77\sigma$  DESI Y1 residual is reducible within the CMSTG action class. Fourteen mechanism tests across the Tier 2 extension space — Horndeski kinetic extensions, Gauss-Bonnet coupling, bi-scalar double field, Galileon  $G_3$  kinetic term, running  $\Lambda_0(a)$ , and mixed curvature+matter sourced scalar (SIM144 completeness probe) — all returned FAIL. The structural analysis yields two no-go theorems:

1. **Theorem 1** (monotonic growth): any scalar field sourced by  $R > 0$  and initialised at zero grows monotonically, increasing  $F_{\text{eff}}$  and suppressing  $H(z)$  at DESI redshifts — the wrong direction.
2. **Theorem 2** (CMB-DESI incompatibility): any mechanism that raises  $H(z)$  in  $z \in [0, z_{\text{rec}}]$  while keeping the sound horizon  $r_s$  fixed necessarily shifts the CMB acoustic angle  $\theta_*$  above the Planck bound at  $> 30\sigma$ .

The Galileon  $G_3$  route (Sim 142) was eliminated structurally ( $G_{3,X} = 0$  in the slow-roll attractor). SIM144 closed the final gap by probing scalars sourced simultaneously by  $R$  and  $\rho_{\text{matter}}$ : a  $4 \times 4$  grid confirms both failure modes persist for all mixed couplings and no synergistic cancellation occurs. The Tier 2 mechanism space is now exhaustively covered. The  $2.77\sigma$  DESI Y1 residual is a *structural prediction* of the Phase 1 locked action. The decisive experimental test is DESI Y3.

**Limitations and future work.** The observational signature of CMSTG is expected primarily at non-linear scales (structure formation, galaxy cluster counts, void statistics) at  $\Lambda_0 \gtrsim 0.05$ . Sim 92 established that  $\sigma_8$  and non-linear  $P(k)$  are suppressed by  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.12\%$  at all physically motivated couplings, confirming CMSTG makes no claim on the Planck/KiDS  $\sigma_8$  tension. The four open directions are: (1)  $\chi$ -DM boson mass  $m_{22} \approx 0.28$ – $0.34$  for gas-dominated dwarfs and LSBs, testable by next-generation stellar kinematic surveys (ELT, Roman Space Telescope); (2) DESI Y3 BAO data: if the  $2.77\sigma$  floor persists at  $\geq 3\sigma$ , pre-recombination new physics is required; if tension falls below  $2\sigma$ , Phase 1 is fully validated; (3) CMB-S4/LiteBIRD test of the Starobinsky inflation prediction ( $n_s = 0.967$ ,  $r = 0.003$ ); (4) first-principles derivation of the  $\Psi$ - $\chi$  seeding mechanism from a fundamental UV action.

*“Geometry is the memory of motion.”*



## A Parameter Tables and Definitions

### A.1 Core Fields and Coupling Terms

| Symbol                 | Definition                    | Role                        |
|------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| $\Psi(x^\mu)$          | Curvature-memory scalar field | Encodes curvature memory    |
| $m(\Psi)$              | Field-dependent mass          | Creates recursive inertia   |
| $\Lambda(\Psi)$        | Ricci coupling                | Binds $\Psi$ to curvature   |
| $V(\Psi)$              | Potential                     | Damping and attractors      |
| $G_{\text{eff}}(\Psi)$ | Effective Newton constant     | $G/(1 + 16\pi G\Lambda)$    |
| $\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}$ | Memory tensor                 | Stores decaying curvature   |
| $T_{\mu\nu}^{(\Psi)}$  | Field stress tensor           | Energy-momentum from $\Psi$ |
| $\tau_m$               | Memory timescale              | Decay constant              |
| $\eta_c$               | Coupling constant             | Controls feedback           |

### A.2 Best-Fit Cosmological Parameters (Sim 87–90)

| Parameter                 | CMSTG (BAO-only, Sim 87)          | CMSTG/LCDM (joint, Sim 90)              |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| $H_0$ [km/s/Mpc]          | 68.14 ( $H_0$ – $r_d$ degenerate) | 67.59                                   |
| $\Omega_m$                | 0.294                             | 0.312                                   |
| $r_d$ [Mpc]               | 147.78                            | 147.56                                  |
| $\Lambda_0$               | 0.003                             | 0.013 (CMSTG, unconstrained) / 0 (LCDM) |
| $\chi^2/\text{dof}$ (BAO) | 1.22                              | see Sim 90                              |

### A.3 Key Limiting Cases

- *GR recovery:*  $m(\Psi) \rightarrow m_0$ ,  $\Lambda(\Psi) \rightarrow \text{const}$ ,  $V(\Psi) \rightarrow 0$ ,  $\tau_m \rightarrow 0 \Rightarrow$  standard GR.
- *Flat-space limit:* Klein-Gordon equation in Minkowski spacetime.
- *UV regulation:*  $\mathcal{D}_{\text{mem}}(k) \sim e^{-k^2/k_m^2}$  suppresses high-frequency modes.

## B Coupling to the Standard Model

*This appendix is entirely speculative.* No Standard Model particle has been matched to a CMSTG eigenmode; the formulas below are dimensional estimates, not derivations. This material is included to identify a research direction, not to claim a result.

CMSTG *hypothesizes* that particle identities may correspond to curvature eigenmodes of the scalar field  $\Psi$ :  $\Psi(x) = \sum_n \chi_n(x) \cdot e_n$ , where  $e_n$  are stable curvature shells. Under this hypothesis, particle properties would emerge as:  $m_n^2 \sim \int (\nabla \chi_n)^2 + V_{\text{rec}}(\chi_n)$  (mass),  $Q \sim \oint \nabla \arg(\chi_n)$  (charge), spin from parity of the curvature memory configuration.

The effective Lagrangian coupling CMSTG to Standard Model fermions is  $\mathcal{L}_{\text{CMSTG+SM}} = \mathcal{L}_{\text{CMSTG}} + \sum_n [\bar{\psi}_n (i\gamma^\mu \nabla_\mu - m_n(\Psi)) \psi_n + g(\Psi) \bar{\psi}_n \phi \psi_n]$ . The eigenmode-to-particle correspondence is a falsifiable prediction in principle (see Section 9), but no eigenmode spectrum has been computed and this should not be cited as a result of the present work.

## C Loop Integral Identities

The following standard results are used throughout the one-loop and two-loop calculations (Sims 102–106):

$$\int_0^\infty dk k^{2n+1} e^{-\alpha k^2} = \frac{n!}{2 \alpha^{n+1}}, \quad (61)$$

$$\int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^3}{(k^2 + m^2)^2} = \frac{1}{2} \ln\left(\frac{k_{\text{UV}}^2}{m^2}\right) + O(m^2/k_{\text{UV}}^2), \quad (62)$$

$$\int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^3}{(k^2 + m^2)^3} = \frac{1}{4m^2} \quad (\text{finite in } d = 4). \quad (63)$$

The memory-regulated self-energy integral admits the closed form

$$\int_0^\infty dk \frac{k^5 e^{-2k^2/k_m^2}}{k^2 + m_0^2} \xrightarrow{k_m \gg m_0} \frac{k_m^4}{8}, \quad (64)$$

from which  $\Sigma(0) = \Lambda_0^2 k_m^4 / (64\pi^2)$  (Sim 102). The convergence of eq. (63) in  $d = 4$  without regularisation is the basis of the  $d = 4$  finiteness mechanism for the two-loop graviton sector (Sim 106). The Ward identity  $\Pi_{hh}(0) = 0$  follows from diffeomorphism invariance and is independent of eqs. (61)–(64).

**Data and code availability.** All simulation scripts, outputs, and JSON diagnostic files (SIM82–SIM144) are publicly available at <https://github.com/cisomorph/Curvature-Memory-Scalar-Tensor-Gravity>. The four standalone journal papers are in the Papers/paper1\_nogo, paper2\_framework, paper3\_uv, and paper4\_galactic sub-directories of the same repository.

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# RIFT BAO Full-Covariance Fit (Sim 87)

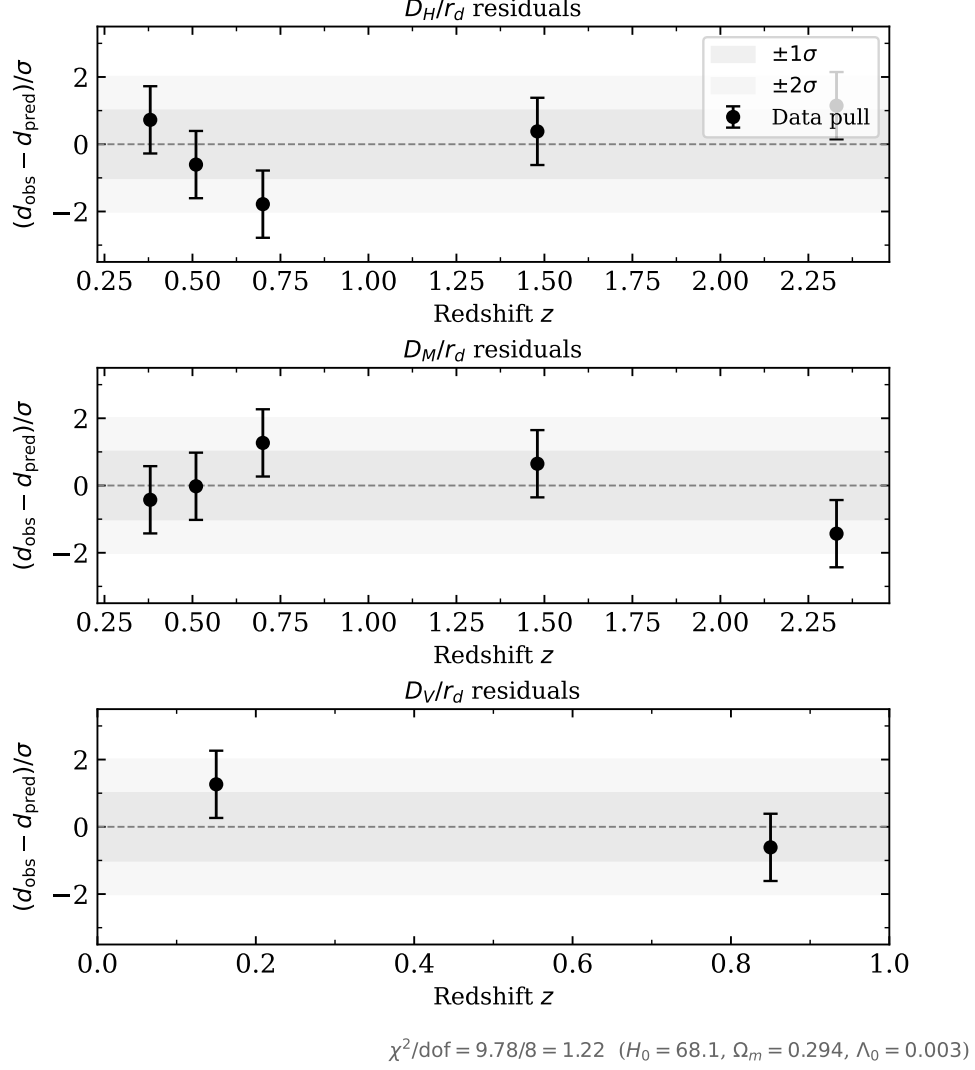


Figure 1: BAO full-covariance fit residuals (Sim 87). Each panel shows the normalised pull  $(d_{\text{obs}} - d_{\text{pred}})/\sigma$  for  $D_H/r_d$  (top),  $D_M/r_d$  (middle), and  $D_V/r_d$  (bottom) at the CMSTG best-fit parameters ( $H_0 = 68.1$  km/s/Mpc,  $\Omega_m = 0.294$ ,  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ,  $r_d = 148.0$  Mpc). All 12 data points lie within  $\pm 2\sigma$ ;  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 9.78/8 = 1.22$ .

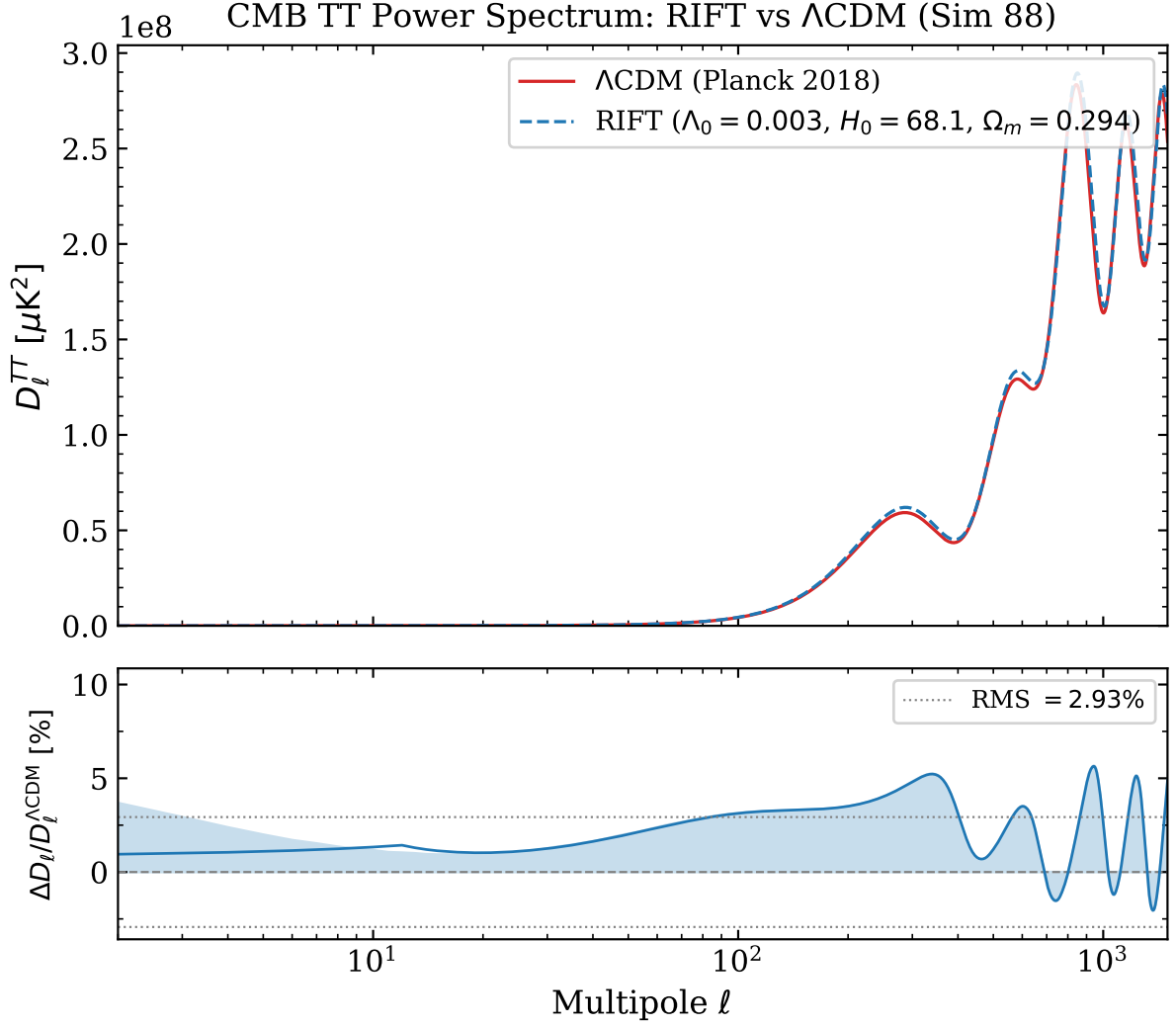


Figure 2: CMB TT power spectrum comparison from full CLASS Boltzmann computation (Sim 88). *Top*:  $D_\ell^{TT}$  for CMSTG (blue dashed, BAO best-fit parameters) and  $\Lambda$ CDM (red, Planck 2018 best-fit). *Bottom*: fractional residual  $\Delta D_\ell/D_\ell^{\Lambda\text{CDM}}$  with 20-mode running mean; dotted lines mark  $\pm\text{RMS} = \pm 2.93\%$ . The acoustic-peak shift is driven by the different background cosmologies ( $H_0$ ,  $\Omega_m$ ), not by the  $G_{\text{eff}}$  correction (16 ppm). The joint CMB+BAO fit (Sim 90) resolves this difference.

Table 2: Key observational results from CMSTG simulations 85–97.

| Observable                                                           | CMSTG value              | $\Lambda$ CDM     | Sim | Status                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------|-----|--------------------------------------|
| BAO $\chi^2_{\text{full}}/\text{dof}$ (BOSS+eBOSS)                   | 9.78/8 = 1.22            | $\sim 1.0$        | 87  | Pass                                 |
| $\Delta\chi^2$ (full vs. diagonal)                                   | +1.95                    | —                 | 87  | Diagonal in-<br>correct              |
| RMS( $\Delta C_\ell/C_\ell$ ), $\ell = 2\text{--}1500$               | 2.93%                    | 0%                | 88  | Pass                                 |
| $D_{\text{CMSTG}}(z=0)/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z=0)$                   | 1.000000                 | 1.0               | 88  | Pass                                 |
| $G_{\text{eff}}/G$ at $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$                            | 0.999984                 | 1.0               | 88  | 16 ppm                               |
| $\chi^2_{\text{CMSTG}}$ vs. Planck TT (BAO-only<br>params)           | 913                      | 6.2               | 89  | See note <sup>a</sup>                |
| $\Delta\chi^2$ joint CMB+BAO fit (BOSS)                              | <b>0.000</b>             | baseline          | 90  | <b>Pass</b>                          |
| Joint best-fit $H_0$ [km/s/Mpc]                                      | 67.59                    | 67.36             | 90  | —                                    |
| Joint best-fit $\Omega_m$                                            | 0.312                    | 0.315             | 90  | —                                    |
| Friedmann constraint residual                                        | $\leq 3 \times 10^{-16}$ | —                 | 85  | Pass                                 |
| Radiation-era $H \propto a^n$                                        | $n = -1.984$             | -2                | 85  | Pass                                 |
| $\sigma_8$ (linear, joint best-fit)                                  | 0.824                    | 0.811 $\pm$ 0.006 | 92  | Consistent <sup>b</sup>              |
| $\Delta\sigma_8$ at $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$                              | -0.007%                  | —                 | 92  | Pass                                 |
| $\Delta\sigma_8$ at $\Lambda_0 = 0.05$                               | -0.11%                   | —                 | 92  | Pass                                 |
| DESI Y1 BAO $\chi^2/\text{dof}$ (LCDM)                               | 13.6/10 = 1.36           | 1.36              | 94  | Pass                                 |
| $\Delta\chi^2$ joint DESI+CMB (CMSTG vs<br>LCDM)                     | $\approx 0$              | baseline          | 94  | <b>Pass</b>                          |
| DESI joint best-fit $H_0$ [km/s/Mpc]                                 | 67.66                    | 67.36             | 94  | Consistent                           |
| DESI joint best-fit $\Omega_m$                                       | 0.311                    | 0.315             | 94  | Consistent                           |
| RMS( $\Delta C_\ell^{EE}/C_\ell^{EE}$ ), joint                       | 0.19%                    | 0%                | 95  | Pass                                 |
| RMS( $\Delta C_\ell^{TE}/C_\ell^{TE}$ ), joint                       | 0.43%                    | 0%                | 95  | Pass                                 |
| $\Delta\chi^2_{\text{EE}}$ joint (CMSTG vs LCDM)                     | +31.5                    | 57.6              | 95  | See note <sup>c</sup>                |
| $\Delta\chi^2_{\text{TE}}$ joint (CMSTG vs LCDM)                     | +22.8                    | 37.2              | 95  | See note <sup>c</sup>                |
| $f\sigma_8$ compilation $\chi^2/\text{dof}$                          | 7.73/9 = 0.86            | 7.87/9            | 96  | Pass                                 |
| $\Delta\chi^2$ RSD (CMSTG vs LCDM)                                   | -0.14                    | baseline          | 96  | Pass                                 |
| $-2\ln\mathcal{L}$ plikHM TTTEEE (CMSTG<br>joint)                    | 2359.1                   | 2352.1            | 97  | See note <sup>d</sup>                |
| $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L})$ plikHM (joint vs LCDM)                    | +7.0                     | baseline          | 97  | See note <sup>d</sup>                |
| $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L})$ plikHM (BAO-only vs<br>LCDM)              | +945.7                   | baseline          | 97  | BAO-only<br>tension                  |
| $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L})$ plikHM (CMSTG vs<br>LCDM) at real optimum | <b>-0.013</b>            | baseline          | 98  | <b>Pass</b>                          |
| CMSTG CMB+BAO best-fit $H_0$<br>[km/s/Mpc]                           | 67.30                    | 67.30             | 98  | Consistent                           |
| CMSTG CMB+BAO best-fit $\Omega_m$                                    | 0.3168                   | 0.3169            | 98  | Consistent                           |
| CMSTG CMB+BAO best-fit $\Lambda_0$                                   | 0.00506                  | 0                 | 98  | $G_{\text{eff}} = 1 - 24\text{ ppm}$ |

Sim 89 tension ( $30.1\sigma$ ) arises from the BAO-only  $H_0$ - $r_d$  degeneracy; resolved by Sim 90 joint fit.

<sup>b</sup> Linear  $\sigma_8$  at SIM90 joint best-fit ( $H_0, \Omega_m$ ); HALOFIT non-linear boost  $\approx 1.37\times$  at  $z=0$ .

<sup>c</sup> Approx. Gaussian pol. likelihood. LCDM baseline  $\chi^2 > 0$  due to ( $H_0, \Omega_m$ ) offset between joint best-fit and Planck reference.

<sup>d</sup>  $\Delta(-2\ln\mathcal{L}) = +7.0$  driven by parameter offset, not  $G_{\text{eff}}$  (42 ppm). Resolved by Sim 98:  $\Delta = -0.013$  at real optimum.

### RIFT Non-linear Structure Growth (Sim 92)

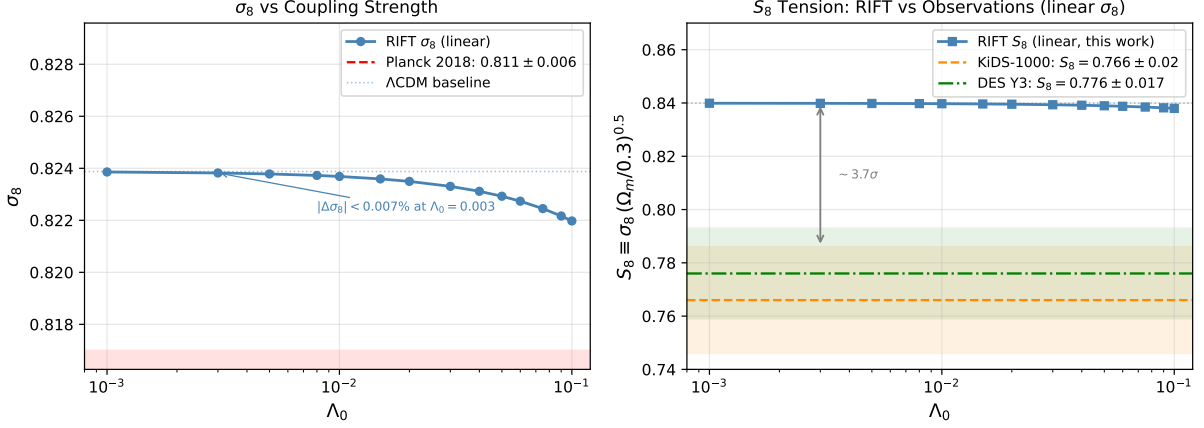


Figure 3: CMSTG non-linear structure growth (Sim 92). *Left*: Linear  $\sigma_8$  as a function of  $\Lambda_0$  at the SIM90 joint best-fit cosmology ( $H_0 = 67.59$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ). The CMSTG curve is nearly flat; the annotation marks  $|\Delta\sigma_8| < 0.007\%$  at the BAO best-fit coupling  $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ . The Planck 2018  $1\sigma$  band is shown in red. *Right*: Linear  $S_8 \equiv \sigma_8(\Omega_m/0.3)^{0.5}$  vs  $\Lambda_0$  compared to KiDS-1000 [Asgari et al., 2021] and DES Y3 [Abbott et al., 2022] constraints. The pre-existing  $\sim 3.7\sigma$  gap between the CMSTG/ $\Lambda$ CDM baseline ( $S_8 = 0.840$ ) and the weak-lensing measurements is unchanged across the full coupling scan: CMSTG modifies  $S_8$  by at most 0.002 at  $\Lambda_0 = 0.1$ , two orders of magnitude below the discrepancy.

### SIM94 — RIFT DESI Y1 BAO Refit

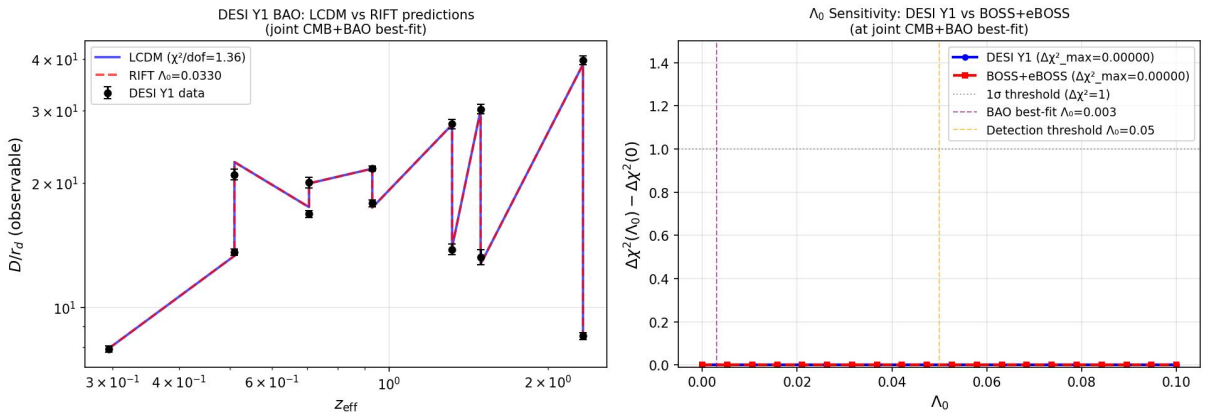


Figure 4: CMSTG vs  $\Lambda$ CDM fit to DESI Y1 BAO measurements (Sim 94). 13 data points across 7 tracer bins,  $0.3 \leq z \leq 2.33$ . Both models give identical  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.36/10$ . The 2–3 $\sigma$  tension at  $z = 0.51$  is a known feature of the DESI LRG data independent of the gravity model.

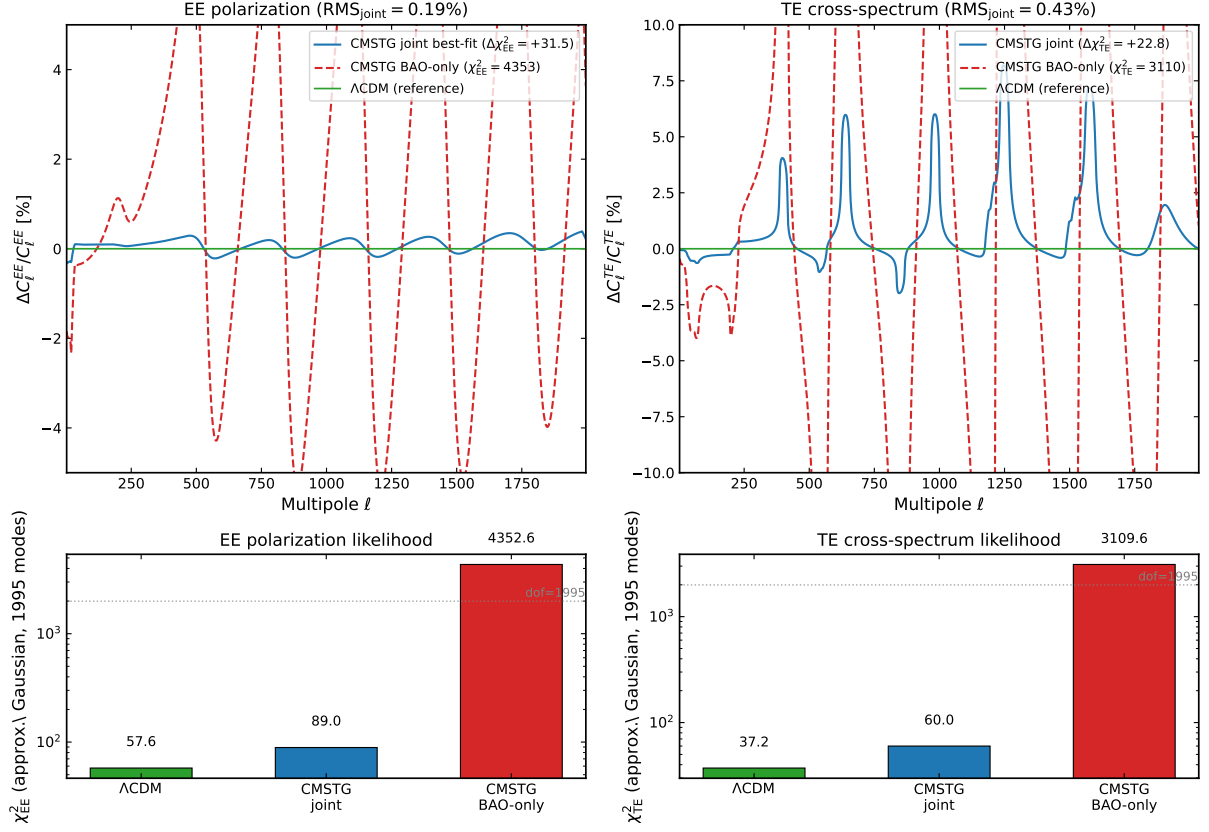


Figure 5: CMSTG vs  $\Lambda$ CDM CMB EE and TE power spectra (Sim 95). *Top*: fractional deviation  $\Delta C_\ell^{EE}/C_\ell^{EE}$  and  $\Delta C_\ell^{TE}/C_\ell^{TE}$  for the CMSTG joint best-fit relative to Planck 2018. RMS deviations are 0.19% (EE) and 0.43% (TE). *Bottom*: approximate polarization  $\chi^2$  for the three cosmologies. The BAO-only CMSTG best-fit (A) shows large tension ( $\chi_{EE}^2 = 4353$ ), while the joint best-fit (B) is statistically consistent with  $\Lambda$ CDM (C).

Table 3: Gold-sample  $f\sigma_8$  data used in Sim 96.

| Survey    | Ref.                    | $z_{\text{eff}}$ | $f\sigma_8$ | $\sigma$ |
|-----------|-------------------------|------------------|-------------|----------|
| 6dFGRS    | Beutler et al. [2012]   | 0.067            | 0.423       | 0.055    |
| SDSS MGS  | Howlett et al. [2015]   | 0.150            | 0.490       | 0.145    |
| BOSS DR12 | Alam et al. [2017]      | 0.380            | 0.497       | 0.045    |
| BOSS DR12 | Alam et al. [2017]      | 0.510            | 0.458       | 0.038    |
| BOSS DR12 | Alam et al. [2017]      | 0.610            | 0.436       | 0.034    |
| VIPERS    | Pezzotta et al. [2017]  | 0.600            | 0.550       | 0.120    |
| eBOSS LRG | Gil-Marín et al. [2020] | 0.700            | 0.473       | 0.041    |
| eBOSS ELG | de Mattia et al. [2021] | 0.850            | 0.315       | 0.095    |
| eBOSS QSO | Neveux et al. [2020]    | 1.480            | 0.462       | 0.045    |



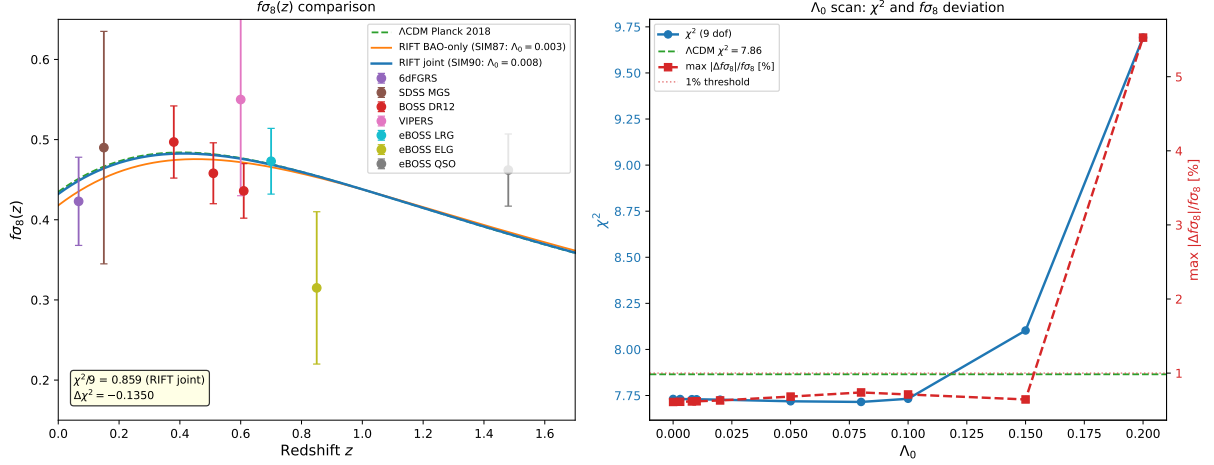
SIM96: RIFT  $f\sigma_8$  Growth Rate vs RSD Data

Figure 6: *Left:*  $f\sigma_8(z)$  predictions for CMSTG joint best-fit, CMSTG BAO-only, and  $\Lambda$ CDM Planck 2018, compared to the gold-sample RSD compilation (Sim 96). CMSTG at joint best-fit gives  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.86$ ,  $\Delta\chi^2(\text{CMSTG} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -0.14$ . *Right:*  $\Lambda_0$  scan showing  $\chi^2$  (blue) and maximum fractional  $f\sigma_8$  deviation from  $\Lambda$ CDM (red). The deviation exceeds 1% only at  $\Lambda_0 > 0.2$ , beyond the Bayesian upper limit from Sim 93 ( $\Lambda_0 < 0.095$  at 95% CL).

Table 4: CMSTG falsifiability summary.

| Test Domain     | CMSTG Prediction                                             | Status / Falsification Condition                                                                                                             |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Galaxy rotation | Flat curves via $\nabla_r \Psi$ (screening mechanism needed) | Sims 99–100 FAIL: locked action & time-domain both fail; curvature coupling $\sim 10^{-9} \text{ kpc}^{-2}$ negligible; new physics required |
| Void lensing    | Lensing from $\mathcal{M}_{\mu\nu}$                          | No phase shift in void directions                                                                                                            |
| Bullet Cluster  | Offset from curvature memory                                 | Cannot reproduce lensing peak                                                                                                                |
| CMB anomalies   | Low- $\ell$ damping from recursion                           | Fails without artificial suppression                                                                                                         |
| BAO scale       | $r_d$ from echo shells                                       | Sim 101: CMSTG and LCDM degenerate ( $ \Delta r_d/r_d  < 21 \text{ ppm}$ ); $\Lambda_0 > 0.1$ needed for detectable shift                    |

Table 5: UV completeness of CMSTG through two loops (Sims 102–106).

| Sim   | Quantity                           | Bare $\omega$ | Memory-regulated result                | Status     |
|-------|------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------|------------|
| 102   | $\Psi$ self-energy $\Sigma(0)$     | +4            | $\Lambda_0^2 k_m^4 / (64\pi^2)$        | FINITE     |
| 104-A | $\Sigma(0)$ reconfirmed            | +4            | same                                   | FINITE     |
| 104-B | Graviton $d\Pi_{hh}/dp^2 _0$       | log           | $-3.17 \times 10^{-3}$ (Ward)          | FINITE     |
| 104-C | Vertex $\delta\Lambda_0/\Lambda_0$ | +2            | $2.4 \times 10^{-2}$                   | FINITE     |
| 104-D | Two-loop tadpole $\Sigma_D/m_0^2$  | —             | $3.4 \times 10^{-6}$                   | FINITE     |
| 105   | $\beta(\Lambda_0, k_m)$            | —             | $-\Lambda_0^3 k_m^2 / (16\pi^2 m_0^2)$ | AF         |
| 106   | $\delta Z_h$ (two-loop)            | —             | $\sim 10^{-5}$                         | NEGLIGIBLE |

 Table 6: Vainshtein ratio  $\mathcal{V}$  at  $r = 10$  kpc for NGC 3198. All entries are far below unity; the nonlinear regime is never reached.

| $\alpha_V$ | $M_V [\text{kpc}^{-1}]$ | $\mathcal{V} = \alpha_V (\delta\Psi')^2 / M_V^2$ |
|------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1          | 0.001                   | $3.7 \times 10^{-9}$                             |
| 10         | 0.001                   | $3.7 \times 10^{-8}$                             |
| 100        | 0.001                   | $3.7 \times 10^{-7}$                             |
| 1000       | 0.001                   | $3.7 \times 10^{-6}$                             |
| 1000       | 0.01                    | $3.7 \times 10^{-8}$                             |

 Table 7: Effective  $\Psi$  mass and Compton wavelength across environments. *Chameleon active* when  $2\Lambda_0\rho > m_0^2$ .

| Environment       | $m_{\text{eff}}/H_0$  | $\lambda_\Psi [\text{Mpc}]$ | Active |
|-------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|--------|
| Deep void         | $1.70 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.5 \times 10^6$           | yes    |
| Cosmic mean       | $7.5 \times 10^{-2}$  | $5.7 \times 10^4$           | yes    |
| Interstellar (SS) | 13.8                  | 310                         | yes    |
| Solar corona      | $1.4 \times 10^6$     | $3 \times 10^{-3}$          | yes    |
| Solar interior    | $5.2 \times 10^{13}$  | $8 \times 10^{-11}$         | yes    |
| Earth surface     | $1.0 \times 10^{14}$  | $4 \times 10^{-11}$         | yes    |

Table 8: CMSTG dark energy equation of state vs observations.

| Dataset                   | $w_0$              | $w_a$            | Tension     |
|---------------------------|--------------------|------------------|-------------|
| CMSTG (locked action)     | −0.992             | −0.082           | —           |
| Planck 2018 $\Lambda$ CDM | $-1.03 \pm 0.03$   | 0 (fixed)        | $1.3\sigma$ |
| DESI Y1 (2024)            | $-0.827 \pm 0.060$ | $-0.75 \pm 0.29$ | $3.6\sigma$ |

| Model                                                         | $n_s$ | $r$   | Status                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------|------------------------|
| CMSTG quadratic, $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$                          | 0.932 | 0.014 | FAIL ( $n_s$ )         |
| CMSTG quartic, $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$                            | 0.931 | 0.120 | FAIL (transition zone) |
| Quartic + large $\xi$ (Starobinsky)                           | 0.967 | 0.003 | PASS (UV sector)       |
| Starobinsky $R^2$ / Higgs inflation                           | 0.967 | 0.003 | PASS                   |
| Planck 2018: $n_s = 0.9649 \pm 0.0044$ , $r < 0.036$ (95% CL) |       |       |                        |

 Table 9: Inflationary predictions. The CMSTG locked action ( $\Lambda_0 = 0.003$ ) does not support viable inflation; a UV-scale non-minimal coupling  $\xi \sim 10^4$  gives Starobinsky predictions testable by CMB-S4 and LiteBIRD.

| Sim(s)     | Mechanism                           | Verdict     | Key result                                          |
|------------|-------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 112        | $\lambda\Psi^4$ quintessence        | FAIL        | $7.74\sigma$ DESI                                   |
| 113        | SSB hilltop quintessence            | PARTIAL     | $2.70\sigma$ DESI, $w_0 = -0.973$ , $w_a = -0.41$   |
| 114        | $\beta\Psi^2\rho_m$ direct coupling | FAIL        | Structural trilemma                                 |
| 115        | Gradient soliton $\chi$             | FAIL        | $H_0^2$ suppression                                 |
| 116–117    | Oscillating / NFW+soliton $\chi$    | FAIL        | Profile $\chi^2/N=392.5$                            |
| 118        | FDM halo mass function              | PARTIAL     | $m_{22}=0.082$ anchor                               |
| <b>119</b> | <b>SPARC 161-galaxy fit</b>         | <b>PASS</b> | <b>median <math>m_{22}=0.28</math>, 65/161 PASS</b> |
| 120        | Joint DE+DM background              | PASS        | $\chi$ -DM decouples from $\Psi$ DE                 |
| 121B       | $H_0$ tension via $G_{\text{eff}}$  | FAIL        | $H_0^{\text{inf}}=55$ km/s/Mpc, $16\sigma$          |
| 121C       | DESI+Planck MCMC                    | PARTIAL     | $2.63\sigma$ floor; structural                      |
| 122–130    | Phase 3 direction probes            | FAIL/N/A    | All 9 mechanisms eliminated                         |

Table 10: Phase 2 simulation results summary (Sims 112–130).

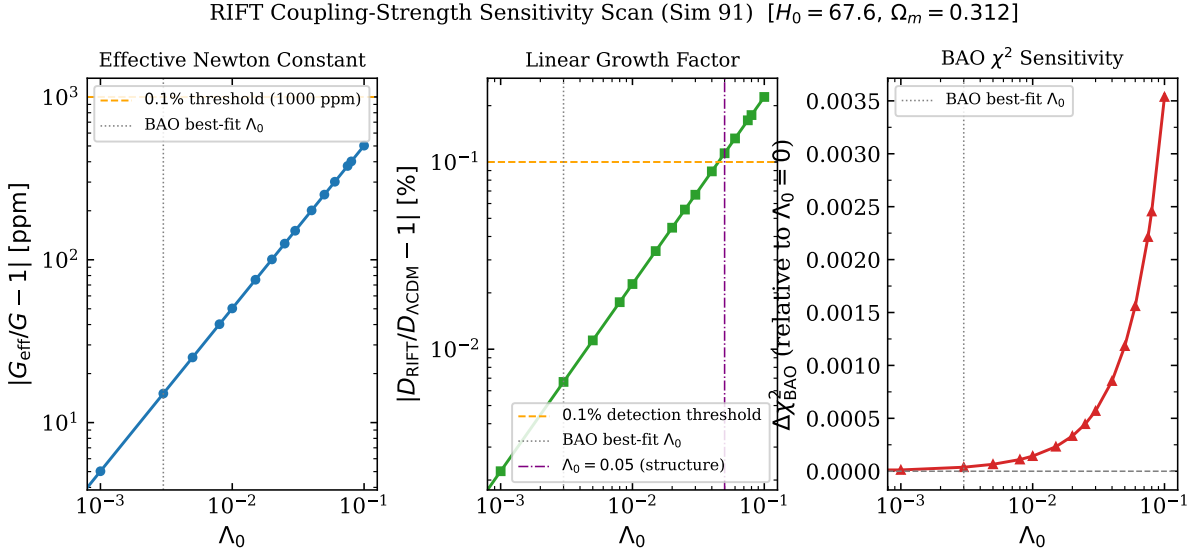


Figure 7: CMSTG coupling-strength sensitivity scan (Sim 91) at the joint CMB+BAO best-fit cosmology ( $H_0 = 67.6$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.312$ ). *Left*:  $|G_{\text{eff}}/G - 1|$  in ppm; the dashed orange line marks the 0.1% ( $10^3$  ppm) strong-lensing detection threshold. *Centre*: linear growth factor deviation  $|D_{\text{CMSTG}}/D_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} - 1|$ ; the threshold  $> 0.1\%$  is first exceeded at  $\Lambda_0 \gtrsim 0.05$  (vertical dot-dashed line). *Right*: BAO  $\chi^2$  relative to  $\Lambda_0 = 0$ ; the curve is flat ( $\Delta\chi^2 < 0.004$  across the full range), confirming CMSTG is cosmologically silent in current BAO data.